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Petition for Permanent Residency under Extraordinary ability (EB-1A)

Petitioner and Beneficiary: Taximov Askar
Classification Sought: Employment-Based Immigration, First Preference
Extraordinary Ability in Science (EB-1A)
Sec. 203(b)(1) INA [8 U.S.C. 1153]
Type of Petition: I-140

Dear Immigration Officer,

This following evidence is respectfully submitted in support of the petition of Mr. Taximov Askar for classification as a qualified immigrant under the first preference employment immigration for Aliens of Extraordinary Ability pursuant to section 203(b)(1)(A) of the Immigration and Nationality Act.

Specifically, the evidence shows that:

1. Summary of Mr. Taximov's achievements and qualifications
2. Mr. Taximov satisfies nine of the ten criteria listed in 8 CFR, Section 204.5(h)(3), namely:
 - i Evidence of Mr. Taximov's receipt of lesser nationally or internationally recognized prizes or awards for excellence [Section 2.1, page 6].
 - ii Evidence of Mr. Taximov's membership in associations in the field which demand outstanding achievement of their members [Section 2.2, page 15].
 - iii Evidence of published material about Mr. Taximov in professional or major media relating to his work [Section 2.3, page 17].
 - iv Evidence that Mr. Taximov has been asked to judge the work of others on a panel [Section 2.4, page 19].
 - v Evidence of Mr. Taximov's original scientific, business-related contributions of major significance to the field [Section 2.5, page 28].
 - vi Evidence of Mr. Taximov's authorship of scholarly articles in the field, in professional or major trade publications or other major media [Section 2.6, page 40]
 - vii Comparable evidence of public display of work (IT Project Management) [Section 2.8, page 57]
 - viii Evidence of Mr. Taximov's performance of a critical role in distinguished organizations [Section 2.7, page 44].

ix Evidence that Mr. Taximov commands a high salary in relation to others in the field [Section 2.9, page 61].

3. Mr. Taximov is one of that small percentage who has risen to the very top of the field of IT Project Management and he has sustained international acclaim [Section 3, page 63].
4. Mr. Taximov's work will substantially benefit the United States [Section 4, page 67].

Pursuant to 8 CFR, Section 204.5(h)(1), Mr. Taximov may file an I-140 visa petition for classification under Section 203(b)(1)(A) of the Act as an alien of extraordinary ability in science on his own behalf.

Pursuant to 8 CFR, Section 204.5(h)(5), neither an offer for employment in the United States nor a labor certification is required for this classification.

1 Summary of Mr. Taximov's achievements and qualifications

In this petition, Mr. Taximov is presented as an IT Project Manager who has been overseeing the creation and implementation of IT, innovative, Building Information Modelling (BIM), and urban technology systems for more than 10 years. His work encompasses architectural design, workflow configuration, development management, and product logic formation, enabling the solutions he creates to function reliably in the daily operations of educational, business and government organizations. In 2008 he graduated from Eurasian National University with honors and he got a Bachelor's degree in Construction with specialization in Civil Engineering. In 2015 he earned his Master's degree in Building and Urban Design in Development at University College London (UCL). His Master's degree dissertation on affordable housing was focused on using IT framework, such as (SDSS) Spatial Decision Support System.

Kakhar Kashimov, CTO, Chief Software Architect, "KazDream Technologies" LLC. An independent industry expert further confirms that this research-driven foundation translated into practical, nationally relevant urban technology solutions. Kakhar Kashimov states:

"I believe that Askar's innovative mindset reflects not only his professional experience but also his scientific approach, which he developed through his research work on creating a new mechanism for determining the necessity of constructing social infrastructure facilities such as schools, kindergartens, and residential complexes, using geographic information systems (GIS) and the architecture of Spatial Decision Support Systems (SDSS). In his scientific work, he proposed a unique IT solution to address the problem of inaccurate forecasting and planning of socially significant infrastructure development across the country. I am confident that his IT developments in the field of social infrastructure and industrial system design significantly influence the scaling of information technologies and remain highly relevant and practical today".

In 2018 he joined the Nazarbayev University Research and Innovation System (NURIS) as a Director of Technopark. During that period he improved Technopark as an attractive place for startup companies, small and medium enterprises (SME) by bringing industrial experts, researchers, technology entrepreneurs and investors together. His next joint IT project was the "Life Signal" service for Android and iOS platforms, developed with the participation of Google and Apple, and aimed at emergency response and interaction of 112 operational services with citizens' calls, including rational allocation and use of emergency-service resources.

From 2019 to 2021, while working at Astana Innovations, the company responsible for Smart City concept integration Big Data urban platform, the creation of analytical models, and the transition from open data to industrial API services, he was involved in the development of IT solutions that form the basis for the automation of interdepartmental processes and the creation of services for

city residents. From March to June 2022, his work at Elorda Qurylys Kompaniyasy, a municipal developer with a public mandate to complete problematic shared construction projects, included the implementation of digital systems for managing budgets, processes, and construction cycles, which required a combination of IT architecture, automation, and management tools. At the same time, starting on January 18, 2022, as an Independent Director of the National Cybersecurity operator “State Technical Service” JSC, he participated in strategic oversight and expert work on platforms that protect e-Government and critical information systems.

Mr. Taximov is currently a Head, IT Project Manager at iKOMEK109 which is similar to the Office of Unified Communications 311 (non-emergency services) in the United States cities. Mr. Taximov joined iKOMEK109 in May 2022, after getting a solid experience in IT sector and his career centers on IT Project Management, Innovations and cybersecurity in government and enterprises. His résumé Exhibit here and diplomas Exhibit here are included. Across roles, he has delivered (i) omnichannel civic-service platforms, (ii) election-grade address/registry data pipelines, (iii) national cybersecurity-operations tooling, (iv) computer-vision deployments at city scale and (v) enterprise digitalization programs.

The documents reflect official recognition of his activities, including letters of appreciation from the President of the Republic of Kazakhstan for organizing the Shanghai Cooperation Organization (SCO) international summit, conducting presidential and parliamentary elections, numerous awards from government agencies, and recognition from Kaspersky for his contribution to information security [Section 2.1, page 6]. Separately, there is confirmation that he was awarded the Bolashak state scholarship to study at UCL, which became the basis for his further professional work in the field of IT Project Management [Section 2.1.2, page 8].

His professional status is reinforced by his membership in the Kazakhstan Information Security Association, where he was accepted by decision of the Council after verification of compliance with the established requirements for professional experience and qualifications [Section 2.2, page 15]. The media has repeatedly covered his work on urban systems, digital platforms, and processes for handling requests from residents of the capital [Section 2.3, page 17]. The materials also include translations of these publications and data on the reliability of the sources.

A significant part of his professional activity is his work as an expert evaluating projects and scientific research. He is a reviewer at the Universities, a member of the jury for national programs, and a participant in expert commissions at Kaspersky, the city situation center, and the National Security operator. Written conclusions on various materials and proposals are presented, confirming the trust in his professional opinion and the importance of expert assessment in decision-making [Section 2.4, page 19].

The results of his achievements are related to the creation and launch of technological solutions that are successfully used in city services and government structures. These include the iKOMEK109

system, which provides round-the-clock operation and reception of calls from citizens to the unified contact center of the Astana City Administration via telephone number 109 and alternative digital channels, as well as a completely updated version of the iKOMEK 2.0 platform, whose architecture and functionality were developed under his leadership and confirmed in documents and published materials [Section 2.5.4, page 39] [Section 2.6, page 40] [Section 2.8, page 57]. A significant milestone was the introduction of the Geonomics information system, which enabled the city of Astana to achieve maximum accuracy in compiling voter lists within its territory by bringing together address data on citizens' places of residence into a single structure, as reflected in publications and confirmed by independent sources [Section 2.1.4, page 12]. The materials also include projects on computer vision, telematics, and network monitoring, under which solutions that have proven their practical value were created and implemented under his leadership [Section 2.5, page 28], [Section 2.7, page 44].

Also presented are his scientific articles on urban analytics, data management, digital services, and security issues, published in peer-reviewed journals from the Higher Attestation Commission list.

2 Initial Evidence of Mr. Taximov's Extraordinary Ability

2.1 Evidence of Mr. Taximov's receipt of lesser nationally or internationally recognized prizes or awards for excellence

2.1.1 Medal "Eren enbegi ushin" (*For Distinguished Labour*). The Republic of Kazakhstan, 2025

On 21 October 2025, Mr. Taximov was awarded the state medal "Eren enbegi ushin" (*For Distinguished Labour*) by Presidential Decree. The certificate and medal set were received, both personally issued to Mr. Taximov [Exhibit 1, page 82][Exhibit 2, page 84].

Mr. Taximov was awarded in recognition of sustained labour achievements in public service and the socio-economic sphere through long-term leadership of large-scale IT projects. Over multiple years, his work in IT project management delivered measurable improvements in the reliability, resilience, and security of mission-critical government and municipal digital systems that support day-to-day public services. These outcomes reflect not only technical and managerial excellence in IT program delivery, but also direct public benefit, including stronger reliability of digital services, faster incident handling, and improved protection of information infrastructure relied upon by citizens and state bodies. The award therefore aligns with the medal's statutory purpose of recognizing labour achievements in fields including public service and the economic and social spheres.

Under the Law *On State Awards of the Republic of Kazakhstan* (12 December 1995, № 2676)

- State awards are conferred by the President to citizens, and where applicable, foreign nationals, in recognition of services to the Republic and labour feats. (Art. 1, *awarded by the President, national scope*)
- State awards are insignia of the highest distinctions, comprising orders, medals and honorary titles. Names of state awards are established in the state language and their descriptions and certificate forms are approved by the President. (Arts. 2–3)
- The list of medals of the Republic of Kazakhstan expressly includes “Eren enbegi ushin”. (Art. 18)
- The “Eren enbegi ushin” medal is awarded to citizens for labour achievements in the economic and social spheres, science, culture and public service. (Art. 21)

Article 1. “Citizens of the Republic of Kazakhstan, in recognition of their services to the Republic and their fruitful state, social, creative and professional activities, labour feats and feats of arms, shall be awarded state awards”.

Article 2. “State awards of the Republic of Kazakhstan shall be insignia of the highest degree of distinction, the order “Altyn Kyran”, the title “Halyk Kaharmany”, “Kazakhstannyn Enbek Eri”, as well as other orders, medals, and honorary titles”.

Article 3. “Names of state awards of the Republic of Kazakhstan are established in the state language. Descriptions of state awards, samples of “Altyn Kyran”, “Halyk Kaharmany” and “Kazakhstannyn Enbek Eri” books, order books, certificates of medals and bestowal of honorary titles, the method of nomination for and bestowal of state awards, other documents, and rules, are approved by the President of the Republic of Kazakhstan”.

Article 18. “Medals of the Republic of Kazakhstan are ... ‘Eren enbegi ushin’ ”.

Article 21. “The “Eren enbegi ushin” medal is awarded to citizens for labour achievements in economic and social spheres, science, culture and public service”.

Public statement about this medal describes it as recognition for contributions to socio-economic development and for services to society and the state, which matches the nature of Mr. Taximov’s public-sector IT impact. This is a national, presidential state award written into law and listed among the medals of the Republic of Kazakhstan. It is conferred by the President and recognizes excellence in labour achievements across nationally important fields. The statutory framework (Arts. 1–3, 18, 21) and the certificate together demonstrate that the medal is a nationally recognized prize for excellence. [Exhibit 1, page 82] [Exhibit 2, page 84]

2.1.2 “Bolashak” International Scholarship. Established by the President of the Republic of Kazakhstan

The Bolashak International Scholarship of the President of the Republic of Kazakhstan was established by Presidential Decree on November 5, 1993, initiated by the First President of Kazakhstan, Nursultan Nazarbayev. The program aims to develop highly qualified personnel in priority economic sectors by funding advanced academic studies and internships abroad. The scholarship operates according to Government resolutions that approve the Rules for selecting candidates for the Bolashak scholarship. By Presidential Decree No. 1569 dated May 4, 2005, the Government of the Republic of Kazakhstan was mandated to approve the Rules for selection of applicants for the award of the Bolashak International Scholarship. Additionally, Government Decree No. 301 dated April 4, 2005, established the Joint Stock Company “Center for International Programs” (CIP) to administer the program.

In 2013, the JSC “Center for International Programs” (CIP) issued two letters confirming that Mr. Askar Taximov is a recipient of the Bolashak International Scholarship. One of the letters is addressed to University College London (UCL) and the other is for the British Embassy Office for visa processing. Each letter is signed by the President of CIP and shows the funded Master degree, with major Building and Urban Design in Development from 23 September 2013 to 22 September 2014.

In order to receive the Presidential Scholarship, Mr. Taximov had to pass a complex and competitive process of selection. The Bolashak program’s selection process is competitive, strict and merit based. It consists of three separate rounds.

Round 1. Comprehensive Testing

The testing process evaluates the candidate’s ability to analyze and comprehend information within a constrained time limit. Candidates need to complete three online assessments with audio and video monitoring

- Verbal Reasoning
- Numerical Reasoning
- Personality Assessment

Only the candidates who met the minimum threshold score proceed to Round 2. No retesting is allowed.

Round 2. Expert Commission Interview

The Expert Commission assesses each candidate’s professional preparation and suitability for the scholarship by conducting an anonymous personal interview. The assessment focuses on the applicant’s level of professional training, theoretical knowledge, and professional competencies in

the chosen field of specialization. The Commission members provide recommendations for each applicant, taking into account the information provided in the applicant's motivation letter.

Round 3. Republican Commission Decision

The Republican Commission for Training Personnel Abroad operates as an advisory and consultative body to the President of the Republic of Kazakhstan. It was established under Presidential Decree No. 470 of October 12, 2000. The Commission is responsible for supervising the implementation of the Bolashak International Scholarship. It has members who are appointed directly by the President. The Commission's chairman is the State Counselor of the Republic of Kazakhstan, the Minister of Science and Higher Education serves as Deputy Chairperson, and the Vice-minister serves as Secretary.

Applicants' materials for the third round are submitted to the Republican Commission for Training Personnel Abroad, along with the results of comprehensive testing and recommendations from the Independent Expert Commission (IEC). In the third round, the Republican Commission reviews the results of the first and second rounds and makes a final decision on the award or refusal to award the Bolashak scholarship, which is communicated to the applicant by posting information on the administrator's official website after the signing of the meeting minutes.

Commission sessions are considered valid only with a quorum of two thirds of members. The members adopt decisions by open vote. A minimum three quarters majority is required for any resolution to take effect.

Each granted scholarship is based on a transparent, merit based decision through this selection process. It ensures highly selective outcomes, as annual applicant numbers reach approximately 10 000, but only around 400–500 scholarships are granted. In 2013, 427 individuals were awarded the scholarship, including Mr. Taximov. Thus, the acceptance rate typically remains near 4–5%, displaying the program's exclusivity and competitive standards.

Both CIP letters state that the Government of Kazakhstan, via CIP, serves as sponsor and guarantor 60 000 USD and covers the expenditures for the tuition fee, living costs (food and accommodation), round trip travel, book allowance and medical examination for the academic year. As documented in the record, the total scholarship funding allocated for the UCL academic year was approximately 100 000 USD. The other half (100 000 USD) of the overall award was used for 1.5 years of preparatory courses prior to enrollment (language training, pre sessional course, and pre master training).

Mr. Taximov intended to pivot into Data Science and IT Project Management work. However, under the Bolashak Scholarship the funded specialty abroad had to be related to the undergraduate degree, therefore he undertook UCL's MSc degree program (Building and Urban Design in Development). To implement this interdisciplinary transition, in his MSc dissertation he used an

IT method, the Spatial Decision Support System (SDSS), for affordable housing needs assessment in Kazakhstan, with a working prototype illustrated in his thesis.

The SDSS IT method included a data collection layer and a Java web crawler for collecting rental advertisements from the main source, the krisha.kz website, and demographic statistics obtained from the national portal stat.gov.kz. Moreover, datasets were stored in a MongoDB database. GIS and base maps were used to prepare spatial boundaries, then displayed through the Google Maps API. The final part of the thesis, user interface and presentations, which included diagrams and page layout refinements, were prepared in graphic software such as AutoCAD and CorelDRAW.

This above mentioned thesis method allowed Mr. Taximov to sharpen his IT experience in a real world project, ultimately serving as a bridge into IT Project Management.

Bolashak is a national, presidential scholarship awarded through competitive, expert reviewed selection with final decisions by the Republican Commission chaired by the State Counselor and comprising senior government officials appointed by the President. The three round selection process rigorously evaluates Bolashak recipients, distinguishing them from the general applicant population with an acceptance rate of approximately 4–5% in 2013. The CIP letters prove individual receipt by Mr. Taximov and substantial value (total 200 000 USD). Although the funded master’s specialization was focused not only on IT, Mr. Taximov’s MSc dissertation anchored his studies also in Building and Information Modeling(BIM), information technologies and data systems, directly supporting his subsequent career in IT Project Management. [Exhibit 5, page 105] [Exhibit 6, page 107] [Exhibit 3, page 86]

2.1.3 Letter of Appreciation for the SCO Summit. President of the Republic of Kazakhstan (2024)

In 2024, Kassym Jomart Tokayev, President of the Republic of Kazakhstan, awarded a formal Presidential Letter of Appreciation to Mr. Taximov for his significant contribution to organizing and conducting the Shanghai Cooperation Organization (SCO) Summit in Astana. The document bears state insignia. From the Letter, *“I express my gratitude for your active participation in preparing and holding the Shanghai Cooperation Organization summit in Astana at a high level.”* [Exhibit 8, page 111]

Under Mr. Taximov’s leadership, the iKOMEK109 Monitoring and Rapid Response Center executed an integrated operational program for the summit that combined organizational measures with citywide IT infrastructure.

Organizational measures:

- Managed 24/7 citizen request operations across public safety, housing, utilities, and other

urban infrastructure through Next ITSM platform.

- Implemented digital monitoring of public channels. It continuously monitored mentions in social media, operator reports, resident signals and escalated incidents in real time.
- Established a unified situational awareness center with reliable IT architecture. This facility integrated cross-agency workflows at iKOMEK109, orchestrating emergency and security services, to ensure timely response to minimize threats and critical incidents.

Use of IT infrastructure hardware and software complexes:

- The city video surveillance complex (IP cameras, video walls, processing servers) monitored mass gathering sites, infrastructure facilities, rail and bus terminals, the airport and key roads and intersections.
- Situational video analytics supported heat maps, crowding detection and tracking of pedestrian and vehicle flows.
- Cyber protection measures included protected data channels (VPN and encryption), server and system redundancy and network activity monitoring to prevent unauthorized access.
- By integrating the system with public safety agencies (police, emergency and medical), automatic routing of alerts and instant interagency interaction were enabled.

The merger of these organizational workflows with surveillance analytics, cyber defense, and real time digital communications provided a high level of safety for summit guests and participants, ensured stable functioning of city infrastructure, and facilitated rapid response to threats in both physical and digital domains.

The Presidential commendation recognizes Mr. Taximov's key role and leadership in applying IT tools to address operations of national significance. The initiative required end to end ownership of mission critical civic platforms, defining processes, orchestrating cross agency teams, integrating hardware and software systems, instrumenting analytics, enforcing reliability and security controls, and operating at international event scale. These are core responsibilities of project and program leadership in the IT Project Management domain.

The "Letter of Appreciation of the President" is defined as an official form of state recognition under the official Regulation on "Presidential Appreciation" (20 November 1996, № 3230). The letter is awarded by the Head of State for exceptional service and achievements benefiting society and the country. The Regulation specifies that each Letter is personally signed by the President and bears national insignia. The Regulation states that the award is formally registered by the Presidential Administration, and entered into the official Registry of Presidential commendations. This established procedure confirms that the Letter represents a formal governmental award rather than a ceremonial expression of gratitude. Accordingly, a personally addressed and signed Presidential Letter of Appreciation constitutes a nationally recognized distinction evidencing excellence and fulfills the evidentiary standard for a "lesser nationally recognized prize or award for excellence in the field of endeavor". [Exhibit 8, page 111]

2.1.4 Letter of Appreciation for the Extraordinary Presidential Election. President of the Republic of Kazakhstan (2022)

In November 2022, Kassym Jomart Tokayev, President of the Republic of Kazakhstan, awarded Mr. Taximov a formal Presidential Letter of Appreciation for his significant contribution to the preparation and conduct of the country's extraordinary presidential election. From the letter, *"I thank you for your significant contribution to the preparation and conduct of the Presidential election of the Republic of Kazakhstan."*[Exhibit 7, page 109]

To ensure accuracy, transparency and security of the electoral process in the capital, Mr. Taximov led an integrated program that combined organizational measures with a citywide technical implementation based on the "Geonomics" Population Database platform.

Organizational measures:

- Standardized voter list and automated polling station assignment by mapping Registration Address Codes (RAC), ensuring data integrity and algorithmic distribution of voters across polling stations.
- Deployed machine learning algorithms and custom SQL scripts to detect anomalies in residence density ("rubber apartments"), leveraging interoperable digital tools to synchronize corrective actions with district administrations and migration databases.
- Managed the digital compilation of the final voter list using secure data pipelines, ensuring data consistency and seamless coordination with territorial commissions for final approval.
- Architected a unified, IT-integrated election call center within iKOMEK109, implementing a digitized knowledge base, automated frontend interfaces, and algorithmic escalation workflows for efficient citizen inquiry resolution.
- Developed and launched high-availability digital services, including a Telegram bot API and web-based lookup tools, enabling voters to query polling station data quickly.
- Implemented real-time data analytics to monitor citizen inquiries throughout the election cycle, utilizing dashboard visualizations to identify trends and optimize support resources.

Technical architecture measures:

- Provided basic platform functionality, use, and adaptation of the "Geonomics" Population Database information system.
- Performed data integration and connection to the state database "Individuals" and other sources to update records, and enabled automatic linking of voters to polling stations by their registered address to eliminate manual errors.
- Implemented GIS visualization, digital mapping of polling stations, display of citizen distribution, territory analysis, and construction of polling station and district boundaries.
- Corrected address geolocation and carried out reception and processing of vector, raster, and attribute data sets with the ability to edit and analyze in real time.

- Ensured security and access, including authenticated access (login with electronic signature), secure export to approved formats (MDB, XLS), and service integration via REST, SOAP, and WSDL.

The Geonomics program delivered highly accurate and up to date voter lists, transparent and convenient citizen services (online tools and a unified call center) and a resilient, secure information infrastructure for the national election. The program combined discovery (legal and stakeholder requirements), delivery (data pipelines, GIS services, voter tools, contact center workflows) and operations (security controls, SLAs, quality gates). It was an end to end lifecycle of a public sector program at national scale.

A Presidential Letter of Appreciation was conferred for the successful conduct of a countrywide election constitutes a nationally recognized distinction evidencing excellence in a matter of national importance. The “Letter of Appreciation of the President” is defined as an official form of state recognition under the official Regulation on “Presidential Appreciation” (20 November 1996, № 3230). The letter is awarded by the Head of State for exceptional service and achievements benefiting society and the country. The Regulation specifies that each Letter is personally signed by the President and bears national insignia. The Regulation states that the award is formally registered by the Presidential Administration, and entered into the official Registry of Presidential commendations. This established procedure confirms that the Letter represents a formal governmental award rather than a ceremonial expression of gratitude. Accordingly, a personally addressed and signed Presidential Letter of Appreciation constitutes a nationally recognized distinction evidencing excellence and fulfills the evidentiary standard for a “lesser nationally recognized prize or award for excellence in the field of endeavor”. [Exhibit 7, page 109]

Accordingly, a personally addressed, signed certificate of appreciation from an independent, internationally recognized cybersecurity vendor such as Kaspersky constitutes a lesser internationally recognized award for excellence and is probative of Mr. Taximov’s distinction in the field.

2.1.5 “Honorary Diploma” for the Presidential Election. Mayor of Astana (2022)

The Mayor of Astana city conferred an Honorary Diploma recognizing high professionalism and organizational skills during the preparation and conduct of the 2022 extraordinary presidential election. The commendation is signed and sealed. From the letter, *“For active involvement, high professionalism, and for organizing and conducting the extraordinary Presidential election of the Republic of Kazakhstan.”* [Exhibit 10, page 115]

The diploma is awarded for Mr. Taximov’s citywide execution:

- Technical organization and updating of the voter database (verification and automatic

distribution of citizens to polling stations based on their registration address codes) using IT technologies.

- Correction of overcrowded registration addresses in cooperation with district administrations and the migration service to ensure data accuracy.
- Formation and coordination of voter lists with district administrations and territorial commissions.
- Development of digital services (online polling station, analysis of voter requests) to support residents during elections.
- Creation of a unified election call center in iKOMEK109 and training of operators and creation of a knowledge base.

Collectively, these systematic measures improved accuracy, transparency and citizen trust in the electoral process. Owning the roadmap and delivery of mission critical civic products (voter data services, contact center operations) across multiple agencies and constraints is a direct application of product leadership. Although conferred by the Mayor of the capital city, the distinction honors work performed for a national electoral event. It is widely recognized within the country and sector. [Exhibit 10, page 115]

2.1.6 Letter of Appreciation for the Day of Digitalization and IT Workers. Mayor of Astana (2022)

Mr. Taximov received an official Letter of Appreciation from the Mayor of Astana for contributions to the development of the city's digital infrastructure and for the introduction of modern technologies into city management (in honor of the Day of Digitalization and IT Workers). From the letter, *"I sincerely congratulate you on the Day of Digitalization and Information Technology Workers ... I thank you for your contribution to the development of our city's information technology sector."*[Exhibit 9, page 113]

As a Head-IT Project Manager of iKOMEK109 in 2022, Mr. Taximov led:

- Expansion of channels for digital feedback by citizens (mobile app, Telegram bots, social networks), allowing 24/7 requests for utilities, technical maintenance, and public safety.
- Strengthening the information security system in the contact center and online services, protecting personal data, and ensuring continuity of service.
- Automating request processing, transitioning from a traditional call center to an analytical intelligent platform, increasing speed and transparency.
- Development of dashboards and analytics to support City Hall's management of incident response and infrastructure planning.

These improvements increased the reliability of city infrastructure and strengthened Astana's position as a regional leader in digitalization. The outcomes reflect project leadership, multi

channel UX, backlog and roadmap control, security and reliability requirements, KPI driven responsiveness and stakeholder alignment at the city executive level. The formal commendation was issued by the Mayor of the capital, and it is recognized as a national government award. [Exhibit 9, page 113]

2.2 Evidence of Mr. Taximov’s membership in associations in the field that require outstanding achievement of their members

2.2.1 Kazakhstan Information Security Association

The membership of Mr. Taximov is confirmed by the signed admission decision of July 1, 2025, with outgoing No. 010725 2. The decision bears the seal of the Association and the signature of the Chair, Mr. Viktor Pokusov. From the letter, *“Approve and include Askar Taximov as a member of the community of information security and information technology professionals.”* [Exhibit 11, page 117]

The record and independent materials describe a national professional association in information security and information technology. It operates across Kazakhstan and unites organizations that work directly in digital systems and security. It is stated in the letter that, *“The Association unites thirty organizations in the Republic of Kazakhstan including competence centers, testing laboratories, manufacturers of information protection tools, universities, research bodies and major operators of personal data.”* KISA Admission Decision (English translation).

The admission decision is on association letterhead and shows the date, signature, seal and outgoing number on the face of the record. It states that membership is granted for work, significant experience and professional achievements in information technology, cybersecurity and project management. It also lists objective prerequisites and confirms that admission is not automatic and is not based on payment of dues [Exhibit 11, page 117]. They include

- Advanced technical education confirming expertise in IT, cybersecurity, systems architecture, digitalization and innovation.
- More than 10 years of professional and research experience, with at least 5 years in IT leadership positions.
- International project management certifications (including Product Owner and Product Manager) [Exhibit 16, page 132].
- Successful completion of advanced qualification examinations such as Program Increment (PI) Planning, Leadership for PI Planning, Iteration Execution and PI Execution.
- Written recommendations from recognized experts in IT and digitalization, confirming an impeccable professional reputation.
- Authorship of original and effective developments and methodologies in IT, innovation and

technology transfer.

- Presentations delivered at national and international conferences.

The level of achievement follows from the multifactor prerequisites, the documented record and the expert review that leads to selective admission.

The letter says, *“A candidate is admitted by the decision of the Association Council. The Council consists of leading professional experts in information technology and cybersecurity, certified information security officers and project managers of national and international level.”* KISA Admission Decision (English translation) [Exhibit 11, page 117]. The record identifies the decision makers by name and title as shown in the decision and on the association roster, such as the Chair, Viktor Pokusov, and council members who hold national leadership roles in cybersecurity and IT [Exhibit 12, page 120]. This shows that applicants are evaluated by recognized experts consistent with the regulatory standard for expert evaluation.

An official entry on the national portal Career.enbek.kz shows accreditation by the National Chamber of Entrepreneurs “Atameken” as a Center for Recognition of Professional Qualifications in information security and in information and communication technologies. As stated in the letter, *“Functions include development of professional standards, standardized competency assessments with employer participation and certification of qualifications in core specialties of information security and information and communication technologies.”* Career.enbek.kz registry entry (English translation) [Exhibit 17, page 134]. This confirms an expert evaluation function in the same field.

Publicly available materials also describe the following activities related to the establishment and national activities:

- Established in August 2017 with the aim of consolidating scientific, industrial, and government expertise to implement national priorities in the field of security and informatization [Exhibit 12, page 120].
- University and industry councils on education and staffing in the field of cybersecurity [Exhibit 13, page 122].
- Public speeches by Chairman Viktor Pokusov on policy and security issues [Exhibit 14, page 126].
- National round tables and consultative events in Astana [Exhibit 15, page 128].

The record shows a professional association in information security and information technology. Membership is conditioned on objective achievements that include education, leadership, certifications, methods and public speaking. The selection is made by recognized experts who serve on the Association Council. There is independent national accreditation for qualification recognition and competency assessment. Accordingly, the record satisfies the membership criterion for associations that admit members on the basis of outstanding achievements, as evaluated by recognized experts.

2.3 Published material about Mr. Taximov in professional or major media relating to his work

One of the key indicators of extraordinary ability is the publication of material about the individual's work in professional, major trade publications, or other major media outlets. Mr. Taximov's work in IT Project Management has garnered substantial recognition in both industry and media, demonstrating the impact and significance of his contributions. Below are some examples of such published material:

- **Kazakhstanskaya Pravda** is a national newspaper that has been published since 1920 and is distributed throughout the country. The newspaper's historical circulation ranges from 80 000 to 110 000 copies each year, and it has offices in cities throughout the country. It also received state honors including the Order of the Red Banner of Labour in 1958. The newspaper has active digital channels its Instagram account has around 160 000 followers and an online portal with a wide national audience. These factors allow it to be classified as a major media outlet in Kazakhstan. This national newspaper article presents iKOMEK109 under Mr. Taximov's leadership as a 24/7 digital response and analytics ecosystem. It highlights integration with more than 12000 Sergek cameras, lists the breadth of connected agencies, and notes omnichannel intake and analytics used to surface risks. The piece references Mr. Taximov and his work, academic background, more than ten publications, the creation of iKOMEK 2.0 and NextITSM, the Life Signal geolocation service with Google and Apple, and GIS and SDSS research for planning. It also quotes him directly and describes results, systems, projects, and research with operational metrics.

"Urban governance digitalization" *Kazakhstanskaya Pravda*, 18 July 2025, Asya Petrova. URL <https://kazpravda.kz/n/tsifrovizatsiya-v-gorodskom-upravlenii/>

The outlet holds a print and online newspaper registration under primary certificate № 16029-SI, issued on 9 June 2016. Its web edition at www.kazpravda.kz was subsequently re-registered under certificate № KZ48VPY00062700, issued on 12 January 2023 by the Information Committee of the Ministry of Information and Social Development of the Republic of Kazakhstan. [Exhibit 20, page 148] [Exhibit 18, page 137] [Exhibit 19, page 141] [Exhibit 21, page 153]

- **ProfIT.kz** is a specialized IT market portal. It has been operating since 2004 with professional coverage for the information technology community in Kazakhstan. The outlet has been awarded the National Kazakhstan Internet Award "Award.kz" in 2007 ranked third among 30 competitors in the Mass Media category and in 2009 ranked second among 60 competitors in Industry and Regional Portals. These awards demonstrate its recognition within the industry and Kazakhstan. The portal organizes major regional and international IT conferences and exhibitions, and maintains partnerships with leading technology companies.

These factors demonstrate sustained professional standing in the IT focused press.

This IT market feature covers Mr. Taximov's PROFIT Contact Day 2025 presentation of iKOMEK 2.0. It cites operational volumes, reasons for replacing the legacy system, and goals of cost reduction and scalability. Features include a unified portal, a field staff application, an updated management panel, and an AI driven knowledge base. The article also notes the planned Situational Map, business intelligence tools including Power BI and Tableau, security testing, and integration with the e-Otinish government system.

"iKOMEK 2.0 a new generation of digital response" *PROFIT.kz*, 13 June 2025. No individual author listed. URL <https://profit.kz/news/70858/iKOMEK-2-0-novoe-pokolenie-cifrovogo-reagirovaniya/> [Exhibit 28, page 171] [Exhibit 29, page 182]

- **Elorda info** is a registered news outlet under Elorda Aqparat. The newspaper publishes daily news on capital city, national, and international developments. It has a significant audience with more than 70 000 followers on its Instagram account. Publications are released in both Kazakh and Russian languages. This interview highlights Mr. Taximov's impact on improving the iKOMEK109 center. It describes 2022 year as a transformation from the call-center to a unified situational center, demonstrating significant results and outlining Mr. Taximov's research activities including six peer reviewed publications, Big Data and Geonomics research, and civic IT transformations. It also notes his participation in international forums, AI testing for classification and routing, and continued infrastructure and service upgrades.

"iKOMEK109 more than 15 million requests how the single contact center changes the capital's life" *Elorda.info*, 26 May 2025, journalist: Sanjar Tashibai. URL <https://ru.elordainfo.kz/novosti-stolitsy-ru/ikomek109-bolee-15-millionov-obrashcheniy-kak-edinyy-kontakt-centr-menyaet-zhizn-stolitsy>

Elorda.info is registered as a network edition under certificate № N16386-SI, issued on 10 March 2017 by the Committee of State Control in the field of communications, informatization, and mass media under the Ministry of Information and Communications of the Republic of Kazakhstan. [Exhibit 25, page 164] [Exhibit 26, page 167] [Exhibit 27, page 169]

- **DALA NEWS** is registered as a news agency. Dala News maintains a public social media presence with more than 12000 followers on its Instagram account. The outlet publishes daily content covering domestic and international news. The article describes Mr. Taximov's leadership of iKOMEK109 and its transformation. It highlights key improvements implemented under Mr. Taximov's direction. The article notes his master's degree from UCL funded by the Bolashak government scholarship. It also reports on his public presentations at major forums and his official recognition. Additionally, it mentions his earlier roles in innovation and strategy, his board service in state cybersecurity, and his registered software and peer reviewed publications.

"From the Bolashak scholarship to the smart city Askar Taximov's leadership and IT transformation of iKOMEK109" *DALA NEWS*, 7 October 2025, journalist: Aqtoty Zhapatova. URL <https://dalanews.kz/kz/article/ot-stypendyy-bolashaq-doumno-goroda-lyderstvo-askara-taksymova-y-it-transformasya-ikomek109.html>

Dala News operates under mass media registration certificate № 16312-IA, issued on 24 January 2017 by the Ministry of Information and Communications of the Republic of Kazakhstan. [Exhibit 22, page 155] [Exhibit 23, page 160] [Exhibit 24, page 162]

- **ErtenMedia.kz** is a registered Kazakh language media portal. The outlet operates a multi platform distribution model with significant reach. It has approximately 40 000 followers on Instagram, about 13000 followers on Telegram, and approximately 90 000 followers on TikTok. This interview outlines Mr. Taximov's leadership of iKOMEK109 as a citywide digital response and analytics system. It reports significant improvements achieved under Mr. Taximov's leadership. It describes the 2022 year transformation into a *situational center* aligned with ITSM and Smart City practices. The article highlights Mr. Taximov's research record including peer reviewed publications and ongoing AI testing for automatic classification and routing, along with continued infrastructure and service upgrades. Together, these publications constitute material about Mr. Taximov, naming and quoting him and describing his work in IT project leadership.

"iKOMEK109 15 million plus requests how the single contact center changes the capital's life" *ErtenMedia.kz*, 26 May 2025, journalist: Asylkhan Boribai. URL <https://ertenmedia.kz/ikomek109-bolee-15-millionov-obrashhenij-kak-edinyj-kontakt-centr-menyaet-zhizn-stolicy/>

ErtenMedia.kz is registered under certificate № KZ09VPY00095412, issued on 25 June 2024 by the Information Committee of the Ministry of Information and Social Development of the Republic of Kazakhstan. [Exhibit 30, page 184] [Exhibit 31, page 192]

2.4 Evidence that Mr. Taximov has been asked to judge the work of others in the same or an allied field

2.4.1 Astana International University (AIU) - Permanent independent peer reviewer of the university journal

The President of Astana International University confirms on institutional letterhead that Mr. Taximov is a permanent independent reviewer of the scientific journal of our university "*International Science Reviews. Natural Sciences and Technologies series*". The letter specifies that, considering Mr. Taximov's expertise in IT and innovation, he "*considers and evaluates scientific*

works and articles in innovative and information technology areas” including topics such as “*use of Big Data in managing national companies, introduction of information technologies in startup projects, creation of technologies for data analysis in social projects, use of artificial intelligence in engineering systems and the use of Data Science when forming information security*” (English translation of the official letter) [Exhibit 32, page 194].

The same AIU letter describes the substantive peer review functions performed by Mr. Taximov. He “*assesses the relevance of the topic studied, the authenticity of the presented facts, the argumentation and clarity of the author’s exposition and conclusions*” and, crucially, “*formulates a decision on the admission of the article, the possibility or impossibility of publication in the above mentioned journal or the need for further revision*” (English translation) [Exhibit 32, page 194].

These statements prove actual participation with publish, revise, and decline outcomes, as required by USCIS. AIUs journal portal identifies the reviewed venue as (*International Science Reviews. Natural Sciences and Technologies Series*) with ISSN 2707 4862 and owned by ‘Astana International University’ LLP (Astana, Kazakhstan). Its thematic focus is explicitly “*devoted to research in the field of natural sciences . . . as well as technologies such as information technology, information security, engineering, metallurgy and oil and gas production and processing*” and the periodicity is “*4 times a year*” [Exhibit 33, page 197].

Due to the fact that the journals scope expressly includes information technology and information security the works judged are in the same or allied field to IT Project Management. AIUs own overview states the university’s mission is “*to provide a high level of knowledge and competence . . . through academic excellence, research and innovation to serve the nation and the world*” and its vision is to be “*a modern global university generating and disseminating knowledge, research and innovation for the Eurasian space.*” Among listed priorities are *conducting fundamental and applied research and training in information and communication technologies* [Exhibit 34, page 200].

Public profiles and institutional pages confirm the university’s academic activity:

- The official Instagram profile confirms AIU operates as a higher education institution in Astana [Exhibit 35, page 203].
- The university’s website outlines its mission to provide knowledge through research and innovation [Exhibit 34, page 200].
- The journal portal lists ISSN 2707 4862 and confirms the scope covers information technology and security [Exhibit 33, page 197].

These sources prove the judging occurred in a recognized scholarly venue [Exhibit 35, page 203] [Exhibit 34, page 200] [Exhibit 33, page 197].

2.4.2 L.N. Gumilyov Eurasian National University (ENU) - Permanent reviewer of the university journal "Vestnik ENU"

The Department of Science and Commercialization of L.N. Gumilyov Eurasian National University confirms that Mr. Taximov *"is indeed a reviewer of the scientific journal 'Vestnik of L.N. Gumilyov Eurasian National University' and on a permanent basis participates in the evaluation of scientific articles"* on topics including *"the introduction of information and innovative technologies in companies, trends in IT technologies and their effective influence on regional development, Data Science as an instrument to increase business profitability, SQL and Data analytics"* (English translation of the official letter) [Exhibit 36, page 205].

ENU specifies that Mr. Taximov reviews submissions for *"scientific novelty, the relevance of the problem, scientific and practical significance of the research, depth of elaboration of the topic, style of presentation and innovative approach to the scientific work"* and, based on that assessment, *"makes a conclusion on the advisability of publishing the article or the need for rejection or revision"* (English translation) [Exhibit 36, page 205]. This demonstrates that Mr. Taximov actually judged manuscripts and issued accept revise reject decisions.

ENU describes a research ecosystem with over 160 scientific projects. These include mathematical modeling and high technologies [Exhibit 37, page 208]. The university holds special status and international recognition [Exhibit 38, page 211]. Mr. Taximov reviewed Data Science and IT trends here. This work aligns with IT Project Management. Public sources confirm ENU's standing:

- The verified Instagram profile corroborates the university's identity and visibility [Exhibit 40, page 218].
- Official pages detail research centers, laboratories, and international accreditations [Exhibit 38, page 211] [Exhibit 37, page 208].
- QS World University Rankings place ENU high in Central Asia. This validates the university's reputation [Exhibit 39, page 215].

These sources confirm ENU is a recognized scholarly venue, and that Mr. Taximov was a permanent reviewer of the scientific journal 'Vestnik' [Exhibit 38, page 211] [Exhibit 37, page 208] [Exhibit 39, page 215] [Exhibit 40, page 218].

2.4.3 Public Foundation "ITeachMe" - Independent Expert and Jury Member (OrleTECH finals)

The Public Foundation "ITeachMe" (Center for Competence Development) is a national nonprofit organization in Kazakhstan dedicated to developing digital skills, creativity, and employability, with a strong emphasis on inclusion. Its programs are designed to support socially vulnerable

groups, including persons with disabilities, by offering training in Kazakh, Russian, and sign language, as well as dedicated inclusive educational tracks. Through flagship initiatives such as OrleTECH, the foundation partners with major stakeholders, including Samruk Kazyna Trust, Shell Kazakhstan, and leading technology platforms.

The OrleTECH curriculum combines a three stage national competition, an offline Soft Skills camp, three months of intensive online Hard Skills training, and a final diploma defense before a professional jury, followed by a public awards ceremony. The foundation reports strong outcomes, including a 90 percent employment rate among participants, more than 180 graduates, over 80 Soft Skills camp participants, and cooperation with more than 40 employer partners. This institutional profile confirms that jury service at OrleTECH is a professional, selective, and nationally visible activity directly aligned with the IT and AI field.

The Public Foundation “ITeachMe” formally invited Mr. Taximov to serve as an honorary jury member for the OrleTECH finals and awards ceremony. The 2024 invitation states (English translation):

“We invite you to participate in the awards ceremony for OrleTECH graduates and also invite you to act as an honorary member of the jury during the defense of students’ course projects. The defense and ceremony will take place on 28 November 2024 at the Wyndham Garden Astana conference hall ‘Altai’.” [Exhibit 42, page 223]

In the 2023 invitation also asked Mr. Taximov *“to take part in the final of the seventh season and to become an honorary member of the jury,”* with the venue and date specified as Astana Hub on 02 November 2023 at 16:30 [Exhibit 41, page 220].

The official agendas document the structure of the jury reviewed defenses across specific tracks. For 2023, course project defenses before the jury were organized by rooms dedicated to UI/UX Design, Motion Design, SMM and copywriting, Mobile videography, and Graphic design, followed by formal awards blocks. For 2024, the program explicitly listed three judged defenses, NoCode, UX/UI plus Web Master, and AI Specialist, together with the presentation of jury members and a formal jury meeting [Exhibit 41, page 220] [Exhibit 42, page 223].

Within these events, Mr. Taximov’s role as a jury member consisted of participating in live defense sessions, evaluating students’ course projects against professional and industry standards, and contributing to collective jury deliberations and final assessments. Beyond the formal invitations and programs, photographic and social media records document Mr. Taximov’s presence in the jury room during live defenses, further confirming his active participation in the evaluation process [Exhibit 43, page 226] [Exhibit 44, page 229] [Exhibit 48, page 247].

The judged tracks NoCode, UX/UI plus Web, and AI Specialist are squarely within the domains of computer science, information technology, and applied artificial intelligence. The 2023 tracks

likewise covered core digital disciplines, including UI/UX design, Motion Design, SMM and copywriting, Mobile videography, and Graphic design, all of which were evaluated by the professional jury [Exhibit 41, page 220] [Exhibit 42, page 223].

The invitations also describe a multi stage national selection and graduation pipeline. For OrleTECH 2024, more than 1,800 applications were submitted, with 232 students selected after a three stage competition. Following approximately 3.5 months of training, more than 120 graduates completed and presented their projects online, with 50 finalists traveling to Astana for the offline defense before the jury. The 2023 invitation similarly notes more than one and a half thousand applications, with approximately 150 students passing the selection process and completing four months of instruction prior to the jury reviewed final [Exhibit 42, page 223] [Exhibit 41, page 220].

The OrleTECH program materials further describe the three main educational tracks: NoCode, focused on building websites and applications without coding; UX/UI Design plus Web, emphasizing usable and visually engaging digital products; and AI Specialist, centered on applying artificial intelligence to create texts, images, animations, and video content. Program materials also present cumulative results, including high employment outcomes, extensive Soft Skills training participation, and broad employer engagement [Exhibit 45, page 239].

Finally, the foundation's certificate confirms that Mr. Taximov has served on an ongoing basis since November 2022 as an external expert, jury member, and consultant for multiple program finals, including ITeachMe 6.0, ITeachMe 7.0, and OrleTECH 2.0. His responsibilities included independent professional evaluation of projects across UI UX design, graphic and motion design, SMM, copywriting, mobile videography, No-code development, and AI applications, as well as the preparation of expert recommendations and advisory support in the areas of digital transformation and information security [Exhibit 46, page 243].

2.4.4 Kaspersky Lab KZ Expert commission on IT, Data Protection and Cybersecurity

Kaspersky is a globally recognized cybersecurity company founded in 1997, providing security technologies for consumers and enterprises worldwide. Independent industry testing organizations consistently document Kaspersky's high status in the cybersecurity market. AV TEST reports that Kaspersky received nine awards during its 2024 awards cycle, reflecting strong protection, performance, and usability results across multiple product categories. SE Labs enterprise endpoint security testing likewise places Kaspersky among the strongest performers, demonstrating effective threat prevention while allowing legitimate applications to operate without disruption. These independent evaluations confirm Kaspersky's position as a top tier authority in global cybersecurity [Exhibit 66, page 318] [Exhibit 67, page 322].

On official corporate letterhead, Kaspersky Lab (Kazakhstan) confirms that Mr. Taximov, since September 2019 to the present, has been engaged on a permanent basis as a leading expert and consultant participating in an expert commission responsible for the development, evaluation, and analysis of business projects in information technology and data security, including infrastructure digitalization projects and cybersecurity. This confirmation is provided in English translation in the official correspondence issued by Kaspersky Lab (Kazakhstan) [Exhibit 49, page 257].

The same letter details that within this expert role Mr. Taximov performs the following functions:

- researches and analyzes global trends in municipal service digitalization using data analytics tools;
- analyzes projects related to cybersecurity, data protection, and cloud solutions;
- conducts information technology expert review of business projects to assess feasibility and applicability based on available tools and resources;
- provides expert conclusions with comments and clarifications on reviewed initiatives and proposes ideas and development directions for improvement.

These responsibilities demonstrate substantive judging activity, including structured expert review, written evaluations, and professional conclusions that guide whether projects should be approved, revised, optimized, or rejected [Exhibit 49, page 257].

All subject areas reviewed by the expert commission, including enterprise IT projects, data protection systems, cloud solutions, cybersecurity initiatives, and analytics driven digitalization, fall directly within Mr. Taximov's field of IT Project Management. The commission operates within a major international cybersecurity vendor, and the evaluated works consist of business critical IT security projects and infrastructure digitalization initiatives. The requirement to prepare formal expert conclusions and propose technical and strategic improvements confirms that Mr. Taximov judges the work of professional engineering and project teams against established technical, security, and operational standards.

The confirmation letter bears Kaspersky's official corporate letterhead, including the Kazakhstan office address, corporate contact details, institutional seal, and the Managing Director's signature, providing direct points of verification. Independent third party evaluations from AV TEST and SE Labs, together with international media reporting, further substantiate Kaspersky's role as a distinguished and globally recognized authority in cybersecurity. In this context, Mr. Taximov's long term service as a permanent expert consultant on Kaspersky's expert commission represents judging activity of high professional significance within the same allied field [Exhibit 49, page 257].

2.4.5 iKOMEK109 (Governance of Astana) - Permanent member of the Commission on Digital Development

The City Center of Monitoring and Rapid Response of the Governance of Astana (iKOMEK109) confirms on official letterhead that Mr. Taximov has served since September 2022 as a permanent member of the Commission on Digital Development and the Use of Information Technologies performing expert activities focused on the analysis, evaluation and development of digital initiatives [Exhibit 50, page 259].

The same letter specifies the judging work Mr. Taximov performs and the outcomes of his reviews:

- **Evaluation and expert review of digital initiatives.** Reviews digital-transformation proposals, checks feasibility and expected business value, and assesses risks of implementing new solutions. Provides an expert conclusion on whether initiatives should be approved, revised, or rejected.
- **Internal policies and governance for IT implementation.** Analyzes and updates internal rules, policies, and guidelines that govern technology deployment. Reviews how relevant legal requirements and international practices apply to the company and recommends practical improvements to keep processes compliant and workable.
- **Implementation oversight and performance control.** Monitors delivery of approved IT projects, reviews KPI results, and identifies gaps. Prepares recommendations to optimize performance and improve impact on business processes.
- **Information security and data protection.** Assesses whether proposed and implemented solutions meet cybersecurity and personal-data requirements. Identifies key risks in data processing and storage and recommends concrete safeguards (for example, stronger access control, encryption, and monitoring).
- **Technology scouting and strategic recommendations.** Tracks emerging technologies (AI, big data, automation, digital platforms), evaluates where they can realistically improve operations, and recommends the most promising options aligned with the company's priorities.

Based on these evaluations Mr. Taximov forms recommendations on adoption approval, coordination, revision or refusal of the reviewed documents and initiatives issuing written conclusions where inconsistencies are found [Exhibit 50, page 259]. All reviewed matters enterprise IT, digital platforms, AI big data initiatives, automation and information security compliance ZTA, ISO 27001, GDPR, NIST belong to Mr. Taximov's field of IT Project Management satisfying USCISs same or allied field requirement.

iKOMEK109 functions as the city's 24/7 monitoring center. The official site lists city metrics and the administration roster [Exhibit 55, page 270].

Public evidence confirms its scale:

- The government portal identifies iKOMEK109 as the single contact point. It offers over 2,500 services and resolves most requests immediately [Exhibit 53, page 266].
- A Senate press release reports that Senate Deputy Andrey Lukin visited iKOMEK109 and highlights its performance in 2025, including that over 90% of requests were reviewed on time [Exhibit 58, page 292].
- The verified Instagram profile displays over 230 000 followers. This confirms its public prominence [Exhibit 54, page 268].

2.4.6 JSC “State Technical Service” (STS) - Expert commission on information security and digitalization

JSC “State Technical Service” certifies on official letterhead (seal and signature) that since January 2022 Mr. Taximov has been engaged on a permanent basis as (i) an external expert on technology transfer, information security and digitalization and (ii) an Independent Director Board member. He takes part as a lead expert analyst in the expert commission evaluating the information security posture of e government informatization facilities to identify threats incidents and ensure secure operation and data protection [Exhibit 51, page 262].

The STS certificate details concrete judging work and outcomes including:

- Expert review of submissions on IS posture of e government facilities analysis of incidents threats with mitigation and data protection recommendations.
- Line by line review of draft normative legal acts on information security, digitalization and AI at informatization objects written expert comments and conclusions.
- Independent Director oversight of technical projects business process design for trials of the Synaq portal pilot testing of the National video monitoring system data collection processing design for CyberDigest review of an IP address packet filtering module.
- Issuance of formal expert opinions recommending adoption, revision or rejection of reviewed projects normative acts [Exhibit 51, page 262].

All judged matters information security architectures and controls, cybersecurity compliance, AI use within state informatization systems and national digital platforms are within Mr. Taximov’s field of IT Project Management.

STS is formally recognized as the technological core of Kazakhstans cyber shield Its official public pages describe mission and monopoly functions including Unified Internet e mail gateways for e government testing informatization facilities for IS compliance coordination monitoring of incidents operation of the National Video Monitoring System SOC functions and national certification authority [Exhibit 59, page 295]. Independent corroboration includes the following:

- STS official website (English and About pages) provides mission statements national scale statistics (blocked attacks, DDOS mitigation) and partner logos confirming its status as the state designated cyber defense operator [Exhibit 59, page 295].
- STS verified Instagram profile shows public facing communication as a national enterprise corroborating STSs visibility and reputation [Exhibit 60, page 300].

2.4.7 Elorda Qurylys Kompaniyasy (EQK) - Enterprise expert commissions

Elorda Qurylys Kompaniyasy (EQK) confirms that since March 15, 2022 Mr. Taximov has been engaged on an ongoing basis as an expert in information technologies and innovation to review matters and projects related to the introduction and development of these areas in the company [Exhibit 52, page 264]. The letter, signed by the General Director specifies that Mr. Taximov:

- analyzes technological solutions proposed for optimization of construction processes and asset management;
- evaluates innovative technologies to increase the efficiency and quality of construction projects;
- conducts detailed research of automation digitalization projects to determine applicability for each site;
- analyzes risks and opportunities related to introducing IT solutions in civil construction;
- consults on integration of innovative systems and technologies into existing business processes.

Based on the above Mr. Taximov prepares analytical reports and expert conclusions on feasibility and implementation for each matter considered [Exhibit 52, page 264]. The judging concerns enterprise digitalization, automation and integration of IT solutions squarely within Mr. Taximov's field of IT Project Management.

EQK is a municipal developer tasked with completing shared equity housing projects in Astana. Its public footprint substantiates its scale and credibility:

- Official EQK website details the companys mission, mandate to resolve shared equity housing, delivered residential complexes and project portfolio [Exhibit 61, page 302].
- Verified Instagram profile shows nearly 470 posts (2025) demonstrating active communication with the public and transparency about delivering 141 buildings for 15,500+ families [Exhibit 62, page 306].

2.5 Evidence of Mr. Taximov’s original scientific and business related contributions of major significance to the field

2.5.1 National IT infrastructure and cybersecurity

Mr. Taximov managed large scale IT and cybersecurity projects affecting banks, ministries and national e-government systems.

Askar Zhunisbek. Chairman of the Management Board, JSC “State Technical Service” (STS)

Askar Zhunisbek characterizes Mr. Taximov not only as a contributor to internal operations, but as a nationally consequential cybersecurity and digitalization professional. In his recommendation letter, he describes Mr. Taximov as *“an outstanding professional in the field of information technologies and innovative developments, whose activity has left a significant mark in the development of digitalization and security of our country. Over the past six years, Askar Taximov held leadership positions in various quasi-public companies, where he proved himself as a true leader and innovator. Thanks to his initiatives and professionalism, significant projects were implemented aimed at introducing advanced technologies and improving infrastructure in the areas of technology transfer, digitalization, smart cities, cybersecurity, and others... his deep understanding of the specifics of the industry, as well as the ability to apply the latest solutions, made it possible to achieve impressive results.”*

Zhunisbek places Mr. Taximov’s work in the context of critical infrastructure compliance systems, stating:

“Mr. Taximov participated in the development of the Synaq Internet portal, implemented to automate the process of providing the service of testing ‘electronic government’ informatization objects and information systems classified as critical objects of the information and communication infrastructure, for compliance with information security requirements”.

This project is of national strategic importance, as it serves as the primary security shield for Kazakhstan’s critical digital infrastructure and protects the sensitive data of millions of citizens.

Zhunisbek further describes Mr. Taximov’s contribution to Internet-scale vulnerability discovery supporting national cyber defense workflows:

“As part of cross-sector coordination on monitoring information security, protection, and the secure functioning of the Kazakhstan segment of the Internet, in 2023 JSC ‘STS’ carried out work on the development of a search system for collecting information on the security level of devices connected to the Internet ScanKZ, at the scale of the Kazakhstan segment of the Internet. Mr. Taximov played a key role in the development of components of this system. As a result of the development of ScanKZ, the following was achieved: improvement of KZ-CERT’s current

activities for preventing computer security threats through the automatic identification of vulnerable objects on the network,” and “expansion of the ability to assess the security posture of devices in Kazakhstan and worldwide connected to the Internet”.

In addition, Zhunisbek emphasizes long-term industry impact:

“Mr. Taximov’s contribution to digitalization and the development of innovative technologies had a long-term effect on the industry. . . Thanks to his efforts, it was possible to accelerate packet processing with a customized router based on Data Plane Development Kit. . . he optimized the operation of routing and load balancing modules, which made it possible to significantly reduce delays in data transmission and increase the speed of processing network traffic of central servers supporting the information security system. This contribution was highly appreciated by colleagues and partners, and also received recognition at the state level”.

Zhunisbek concludes by directly summarizing the broader significance of Mr. Taximov’s work, stating: *“Mr. Taximov is a professional of the highest level, whose work makes a significant contribution to the development of information technologies and innovations.”* [Exhibit 68, page 324]

Aidos Tokayev. Information Security Officer, City Monitoring and Rapid Response Center, Administration of Astana

Aidos Tokayev states that Mr. Taximov’s work made a substantial contribution to strengthening Kazakhstan’s national digital infrastructure and cybersecurity, particularly through large-scale e-government gateway modernization, high-performance security prototypes, and operational vulnerability-scanning capabilities for government systems.

About the *“Project ‘Maintenance of the unified Internet access gateway and the unified email gateway of the ‘electronic government’ of the Republic of Kazakhstan”* he states that:

“Development of an AI-based content filtering module that allows real-time analysis of Internet traffic and blocking of potential threats. Implementation of a dynamic traffic routing methodology, which increased the gateway performance by 23% and reduced the system response time by 17%. As a result of the project, the system fault tolerance increased, cyber threats decreased, and operating costs were optimized by 157.2 million tenge per year”.

Tokayev further highlights Mr. Taximov’s leadership in project *“Development of prototypes of software products for information security”*, resulting in measurable improvements in speed, latency, and budget efficiency:

“In particular, he led an initiative to optimize DPDK traffic and implement solutions that increased the speed of network traffic processing by 34%. The implementation of these solutions ensured a 40% increase in the throughput of the network infrastructure and optimization of capital expenditures by 104.16 million tenge”.

He also underscores Mr. Taximov's role in project "*Development of a prototype module 'Vulnerability Scanner'*", noting:

"Within this project, scripts for automatic detection of 20 types of vulnerabilities were developed, which made it possible to significantly increase the level of cyber protection of government information systems. Thanks to Askar's impressive work, significant results have been achieved in the areas of information security, digital monitoring, and data management. His contribution to the development of the national IT infrastructure cannot be overstated:

- A 31% reduction in the number of failures in government IT systems.*
- Optimization of government operating costs through the implementation of innovative solutions."*

Summarizing his assessment, Mr. Tokayev provides a broader evaluation of Mr. Taximov's professional significance and long-term impact: "*Summarizing the above, I would like to emphasize that this specialist has not only made a significant contribution to the development of the IT industry, information security, and cybersecurity, but continues to actively shape the future directions of this field. His leadership qualities, strategic thinking, innovative vision, and ability to implement advanced technologies place him among the leading IT professionals in the Republic of Kazakhstan*". [Exhibit 69, page 327] [Exhibit 70, page 331]

Azamat Sanatov, Consultant, Department for Protection of Information Resources, Administration of the President of the Republic of Kazakhstan

Azamat Sanatov states that he worked with Mr. Taximov in an interagency group on building network infrastructure for central government bodies during the pandemic period, when Mr. Taximov served as Deputy Chairman of the Management Board of JSC "Astana Innovations" overseeing IT and telecommunications development in Astana.

Sanatov highlights Mr. Taximov's contribution to backbone connectivity and reliability, stating:

"Mr. Taximov proposed a project to build a modern structured cabling network that ensures reliable and high-speed data transmission. He recommended deploying 100 Gb/s Ethernet switches, which increased network fault tolerance to 99.99%."

He further describes perimeter-security modernization at ministerial networks and its multi-agency impact:

"We also worked with Mr. Taximov on implementing next-generation firewalls that provided comprehensive protection of the network perimeter of ministries by preventing unauthorized access and cyberattacks, while enabling real-time traffic monitoring and control. As a result of this project, we increased the level of cybersecurity of 11 government institutions, improved data transfer speed, and created a flexible and scalable network infrastructure".

Finally, Sanatov credits Mr. Taximov with data-center modernization for e-government-critical systems:

“One of Mr. Taximov’s significant contributions was the development and implementation of the digital project “Data Center”, which ensured high fault tolerance and uninterrupted operation of the IT infrastructure of government bodies and key electronic-government information systems. He proposed equipping these data centers with advanced solutions, including backup power supply, climate control, and physical security, which significantly reduced the risk of data loss and downtime of critical services” [Exhibit 86, page 397] [Exhibit 87, page 401].

Recognition by Kaspersky Lab International for Contributions to Information Security (2022)

Kaspersky Lab’s Central Asia office issued Mr. Taximov a signed and sealed Certificate of Appreciation recognizing his contribution to the development of the information security sector. From the letter, *“Certificate of Appreciation ... for contribution to the development of the information security industry.”* [Exhibit 88, page 406]

The recognition reflects Mr. Taximov’s cybersecurity leadership across multiple dimensions of practical impact:

- Improving the iKOMEK109 digital ecosystem, implementing robust protection and monitoring tools on a citywide, 24/7 digital platform.
- Public private cooperation, partnering with leading suppliers and integrators to improve the resilience of critical municipal services.
- Institutionalization of incident response practices, standards and guidelines for public and quasi public organizations, including measures to ensure confidentiality and data protection.
- Promoting digital literacy and security by design, extensive information and awareness raising activities to improve the security of public information systems.

These contributions are consistent with Mr. Taximov’s concurrent strategic work as an Independent Director at the national cyber operator (JSC “State Technical Service”), on projects such as Synaq (security testing portal), ScanKZ (national exposure monitoring) and an internal cyber media monitoring bot. The work involved defining security requirements, prioritizing features, coordinating delivery across multiple teams, setting acceptance criteria, and measuring impact — project management applied to cybersecurity platforms at national scale.

That this recognition came from Kaspersky Lab, which is an independent, internationally operating cybersecurity company, underscores its significance as an external, industry-level validation of Mr. Taximov’s contributions. The company’s standing in the field is evidenced by:

- BBC News coverage, *“Kaspersky identified the state level “Flame” malware ... one of the most complex threats ever discovered.”* (BBC News report referencing work with the UN’s ITU)

- AV TEST Awards (2024), *“Kaspersky stood out in numerous tests in 2024, receiving a total of nine awards.”*
- SE Labs (Q1 2024), *“Achieved 100% Protection Accuracy, 100% Legitimate Accuracy and 100% Total Accuracy.”* (SE Labs, Endpoint Security, Small Business Protection)

[Exhibit 88, page 406] [Exhibit 67, page 322] [Exhibit 66, page 318] [Exhibit 65, page 315]

Accordingly, a personally addressed, signed commendation from an independent, internationally recognized cybersecurity company such as Kaspersky constitutes credible external validation of Mr. Taximov’s significant and recognized contributions to the information security field.

2.5.2 AI technologies

Mr. Taximov led complex AI and analytic projects across industry and municipal environments.

Dmitry Panchenko. Systems Integrator (Target AI video analytics and urban enforcement)

Integrator Dmitry Panchenko, with whom Mr. Taximov worked for over seven years, describes Mr. Taximov as an *“architect of the digital future”*. Regarding their joint work, Mr. Panchenko writes:

“Among the recent joint projects, I would like to especially highlight the project on the implementation of the Target AI video analytical system within the framework of complex and information support of the vital activity of the city of Astana”.

Mr. Panchenko details the specific scale and technical execution under Mr. Taximov’s leadership:

“Askar led this pilot project for the last 3 years... In the framework of the implementation of the Target AI pilot project, Askar successfully completed the following tasks:

- *connected more than 600 digital video surveillance cameras, located in various districts of the city. To determine the location points of digital cameras, Askar used analytical modules of the HPSM information platform, where information about incidents comes from residents of the capital;*
- *integrated specialized technical modules of Target AI for facial recognition, smoke detection and ‘lost’ objects, ensuring their uninterrupted operation and compliance with such international standards as IEC 60529 and PAL;*
- *developed and implemented a strategy for optimizing the video stream processing system, which provided for the use of artificial intelligence algorithms”.*

Regarding the impact of this system on city safety and enforcement, Mr. Panchenko attests that:

“The system increased the detection of violations by license plate numbers by 37% and recorded 3,755 cases of unauthorized waste unloading by freight transport using artificial intelligence algorithms”.

Concluding his assessment, Mr. Panchenko emphasizes Mr. Taximov's strategic and analytical strengths, stating: *"Askar Taximov possesses unique skills in strategic thinking and innovative problem-solving, which enabled him to effectively coordinate the development and implementation of IT projects. He demonstrates exceptional analytical and technical capabilities, allowing him to accurately set priorities and develop innovative approaches to solving complex challenges"*. [Exhibit 73, page 343]

Dr. Chingiz Kenshimov. Computer vision PhD and co-founder and technical lead of Verigram

Computer vision PhD and co-founder and technical lead of Verigram Dr. Chingiz Kenshimov describes Mr. Taximov's role in their AI startups ABY Applied Systems and Verigram. He credits Mr. Taximov with defining product concepts, directing the research group, and building scalable architectures:

"Askar Taximov... successfully identified market needs, developed product concepts, and set the technical direction for the research team... In particular, he helped us in the development of products related to video analytics and assessment of urban traffic flows, which were implemented jointly with Cisco and underwent tests on the roads of Almaty".

Regarding the technical infrastructure and architectural engineering, Dr. Kenshimov writes:

"At Verigram, he was responsible for developing and optimizing modular code that ensured system scalability and high load support. He developed the architecture of software solutions based on modern frameworks such as TensorFlow and PyTorch... Within the context of work on ABY Applied Systems, Askar developed a hybrid architecture of server interaction with cloud and local computing, which allowed to significantly increase data processing speed... and implemented a microservice approach".

Dr. Kenshimov highlights Mr. Taximov's specific contribution to machine learning operations (MLOps) and model performance:

"Also an impressive contribution... was the creation of an effective pipeline for data processing, including automatic data labeling, model training and their subsequent integration into commercial solutions. His work ensured an increase in the accuracy of model predictions by 15%, which led to improved product quality and customer satisfaction".

Finally, Dr. Kenshimov highlights Mr. Taximov's expertise, noting: *"Askar Taximov possesses unique professional skills and extensive experience, which make him a valuable asset to any large organization or project. I am confident that his expertise and specialized knowledge, as well as his ability to think strategically and develop innovative solutions, will help achieve outstanding results in the field of IT technology development"*. [Exhibit 74, page 346] [Exhibit 75, page 349]

Kakhar Kashimov. CTO, Chief Software Architect, "KazDream Technologies" LLC

Kakhar Kashimov attests to Mr. Taximov's technical leadership in developing advanced hardware and software innovations. He highlights Mr. Taximov's critical role in a joint startup focused on wireless seismic exploration, describing the project's significance and Mr. Taximov's architectural contributions:

"The main essence of this project consisted in the introduction of a wireless seismic exploration system... using wireless terrestrial Wi-Fi geophones, representing seismic vibration sensors, instead of multi-kilometer expensive cables. In this project, Askar dealt with key technical and innovative issues, such as high-density seismic wave analysis, data collection and analytics, increasing the number and density of data collection nodes in difficult terrain conditions. To ensure high data transfer speed... Askar proposed using a two-level system structure... utilizing LPWAN, Wi-Fi LTE... allowing the construction of large-scale wireless networks with a large number of data collection nodes. This technical solution allowed our project to solve key questions on ensuring the required network bandwidth and its scaling... and independent data collection channels".

Mr. Kashimov further details Mr. Taximov's work on "Life Signal," a critical safety integration project involving global technology ecosystems:

"Our next joint IT project was the Life Signal service for Android and iOS platforms, implemented with the participation of Google and Apple, aimed at emergency response and interaction of 112 emergency services with citizens' calls, rational distribution and use of emergency services resources. This project has a large-scale level since the system assumes precise determination of the calling subscriber's location and reduces response time".

Finally, Kashimov provides an overarching assessment directly linking Mr. Taximov's work to substantial, ongoing contributions to advanced technology systems, stating: *"Considering the above, I can confidently state that Askar Taximov has made a substantial contribution to the field of technology transfer and advanced IT systems and, to this day, continues to participate in the development and improvement of modern information technologies".* [Exhibit 71, page 335] [Exhibit 72, page 339]

2.5.3 City scale digital governance and portfolio management

Mr. Taximov led large IT portfolios that govern how a capital city handles requests, elections, and smart city analytics.

Yesset Baiken. Deputy Mayor of Astana (Administration of Astana city)

Yesset Baiken describes Mr. Taximov's city-scale digital governance impact through iKOMEK109's function as the city's unified situation center, where Mr. Taximov's leadership strengthened (1) executive-level escalation of urgent resident issues and (2) measurable improvements in municipal

operations, public safety, and cross-agency performance.

Baiken frames iKOMEK109 as a governance infrastructure that combines citizen intake, integrated monitoring, and Big Data analytics connected to city leadership decision-making.

“iKOMEK is the city’s unified full-scale Situation Center and includes: (1) the iKOMEK109 unified contact center for life-support issues [more than 2.2 million requests per year; an analogue of 3-1-1 in the United States]; (2) the iKOMEK109 monitoring Situation Center, where the city’s CCTV cameras, fire suppression systems, and Internet-of-Things monitoring solutions are integrated for round-the-clock safety and continuity-of-services monitoring; and (3) the iKOMEK109 Analytics Center, a forecasting and analysis unit that works with Big Data to identify systemic problems and escalate issues to the city leadership in order to continuously improve the capital’s safety and living conditions”.

Baiken highlights a specific governance mechanism introduced under Mr. Taximov that brings the most urgent resident problems to the Mayor’s weekly executive meeting and accelerates closure of high-priority issues.

“A new practice was introduced whereby, on a weekly basis, the Mayor’s executive meeting is briefed on the most urgent and high-profile problems raised by residents, ensuring timely and deep involvement of the relevant municipal enterprises; and as a result of the ‘Decision-Making Matrix’ method developed by Askar, by the end of 2023 and the first half of 2024 we reduced the number of ‘Critical’ and ‘Highly Urgent’ issues from 112 to 27, i.e., by 76%”.

Baiken further describes how Mr. Taximov modernized resident-request management and reduced longstanding backlogs through governance-aligned digital tooling and analytics reporting.

“Based on accumulated experience, Askar Taximov proposed developing dedicated functionality in the HP Service Manager system for processing resident requests and surfacing this information in analytical reports; and in 2023 a total of 426,542 requests were closed, which is 28.4% more than in 2022 (332,178 requests)”.

Baiken also links Mr. Taximov’s situational center modernization to measurable public-safety outcomes and direct fiscal impact, enabled through digital platforms and standardized operating instructions.

“As a result of modernized monitoring and data-processing algorithms and new operating instructions for video surveillance, the number of registered cases related to identifying drug stashers through CCTV increased by 17% compared to the previous year; in 2023 the center assisted in solving 23 criminal cases and 19,384 administrative offenses (13,015 formalized by protocol), and due to Askar’s efforts 52,008,750 tenge in paid administrative fines was transferred to the budget through digital platforms”.

Concluding, Baiken explicitly attributes the organization’s outcomes and performance indicators

to Mr. Taximov's management and innovation. *"I note that the above projects, achievements, and high performance indicators are the direct result of Askar Taximov's effective management; and due to his innovative solutions, the organization ensured technological development and digital transformation".* [Exhibit 76, page 354] [Exhibit 77, page 365]

Anuar Beisenbayev. Director of Development Department, City Monitoring and Rapid Response Center iKomek109

Anuar Beisenbayev describes Mr. Taximov's city-scale digital governance impact through (1) modernization of iKomek109's citizen request management and (2) data-driven portfolio execution for election-readiness, where Mr. Taximov's applied systems and algorithms improved the accuracy of critical city records and citizen-facing services.

Beisenbayev highlights Mr. Taximov's role in building and implementing a new CRM platform for managing citizen appeals and automating operational processes at iKomek109.

"Within his work at iKomek109, he made a significant contribution to the development and implementation of a new CRM information system for managing citizen requests and automating processes. The use of modern technologies such as React, TypeScript, Next.js, Prisma, Tailwind CSS, and PostgreSQL made it possible to create a flexible and high-performance platform that improves the quality of public service".

Beisenbayev further describes a citywide election-readiness effort where Mr. Taximov applied GIS systems and data automation to correct records and raise accuracy during the electoral period.

"He played a key role in updating information in the state database of individuals for the city of Astana, as well as in forming the voter list and organizing interaction with government bodies as part of preparation for elections. Thanks to this, it was possible to correct more than 50 000 addresses and accurately link them to the relevant polling stations, which eliminated errors in voter lists and increased their accuracy from 84% to 100% during the electoral period".

Beisenbayev also notes that Mr. Taximov built supporting automation and citizen-facing access channels for this governance workflow.

"Askar developed a data filtering algorithm using the programming languages Java, Python, JavaScript, and SQL, which made it possible to promptly exclude from the list citizens who do not meet legal requirements (for example, minors, incapacitated persons, prisoners, deceased persons, etc.). In addition, online services and chatbots in Telegram were created, which significantly simplified for citizens the ability to check their polling station and obtain the necessary information about it".

Concluding, Beisenbayev emphasizes the high level professional skills of Mr. Taximov, writing: *"I can assure you that Askar is a professional and expert in his field, a specialist with excellent*

communication skills, capable of effectively coordinating work between different departments and stakeholders. His commitment to professional development, attention to detail, and focus on results make him a valuable employee in any team. I am confident that Askar Taksimov's knowledge of information technology, high level of expertise in innovative projects, experience, and leadership qualities make him one of Kazakhstan's best specialists in the field of information technology development and infrastructure project management". [Exhibit 78, page 368] [Exhibit 79, page 372]

Azat Kudaibergenov. Chief Inspector, Department of Digitalization and Information Technologies of Astana

Azat Kudaibergenov describes Mr. Taximov's city-scale digital governance impact through applied data systems that modernized voter list management and strengthened operational coordination in municipal service delivery, while also influencing adoption beyond Astana.

Kudaibergenov describes a city project to update Astana's voter lists and highlights Mr. Taximov's original algorithmic approach and cross-database integration.

"Our cooperation began with joint work on an information project to update the voter lists of the city of Astana, the idea and development of which are described in detail in his scientific oriented article 'How to use the Geonomics information system to update and generate information about city residents'. In the article about this system, Askar Taximov first proposed an innovative algorithm for automatically updating residents' data, which not only improved the accuracy of voter lists, but also created a basis for digital planning of urban infrastructure".

"Its implementation made it possible to form lists of citizens based on a single source, excluding 'door-to-door' visits and ensuring the relevance of data in real time".

He further describes Mr. Taximov's iKomek109 governance model and the operational technologies implemented to coordinate city services.

"In the article 'How to apply information technology tools in improving the life of a city. iKomek experience' Askar Taximov presented an innovative model of an information center based on a three-level request processing system. Askar developed thorough processing algorithms, information architecture, and interaction mechanisms to promptly respond to citizen requests. He also implemented a video surveillance and GPS monitoring system to coordinate the work of city services".

Kudaibergenov says that the approach became a model for replication. *"Moreover, the iKomek109 experience was recognized as successful and became an example for the creation of similar centers in other cities of Kazakhstan".*

Kudaibergenov concludes underscoring his significant contributions: *"Finally, it is undeniable that Askar Taximov's efforts are aimed at creating a favorable environment for the development of*

the IT industry in Kazakhstan. Thanks to his work, the city of Astana is becoming one of the leaders in the field of digital transformation in Kazakhstan, and his projects and initiatives serve as an example for other regions of the country striving to develop the IT industry.” [Exhibit 80, page 376] [Exhibit 81, page 380]

Ainur Sidelkovskaya. IT and Big Data Specialist (Government-level AI & Big Data Programs)

Ainur Sidelkovskaya, a government scale AI and Big Data specialist with more than 15 years of experience implementing enterprise analytics and data platforms, frames Mr. Taximov’s work as directly aligned with modern data governance and smart city delivery models. She emphasizes his ability to integrate operational systems into a functioning municipal service layer, an area that intersects with her own Big Data and digital government practice. She writes:

“At iKOMEK109, Askar facilitated the development of key digital technologies and telecommunications infrastructure, demonstrating a remarkable capacity for integrating complex system”.

She further links his iKOMEK109 work to practical and operational outcomes related to service delivery and citizen facing effectiveness rather than isolated technical tasks: *“As well as the management of constructing a call center and making sure that communication with the IT sector occurs, he converted the call center into a very effective mechanism for enhancing the quality of life for the local inhabitants”.*

From a data governance perspective, Sidelkovskaya highlights Mr. Taximov’s work on Geonomics as a proposed methodology for maintaining reliable citizen data that serves as an essential prerequisite for analytics, decision support, and smart city program execution:

“In his groundbreaking article, “How to use the geonomics information system to update and generate citizen data” Askar addressed the critical challenge of maintaining accurate and up to date citizen data, a fundamental requirement for effective urban governance”.

She underscores that his contribution is not theoretical but positioned as a set of practical mechanisms for integrating, verifying, and using data across fragmented municipal environments:

“He offers specific, practical solutions to overcome real world problems associated with collecting, integrating, and verifying data. This has enormous implications for a variety of areas — from resource allocation and emergency response to long-term urban development strategies. Askar’s ideas are especially relevant in the context of modern trends such as smart city initiatives and digital government programs. As a result, his work offers a roadmap for cities looking to harness the power of data to govern more effectively”.

Given her own background leading government-scale Big Data programs and implementing analytics platforms for major public and private institutions, her assessment provides an expert,

field-specific validation of the significance of Mr. Taximov's municipal data-governance and smart-city integration work.

"... I am convinced that Askar is among the top 10% of specialists in Kazakhstan in the field of IT, digital technologies, urban management and innovation projects. Askar's contribution to the development of digital and IT technologies in Kazakhstan is as he initiates and implements projects aimed at improving the quality of life of city residents. He actively shares his experience and knowledge with the professional community and promotes the development of young IT specialists. He approaches complex urban problems using principles and concepts from modern urban science and IT technology. With his extensive understanding of modern complex city challenges, he is able to solve their problems. Askar Taximov demonstrates standards of professionalism that are second to none. To illustrate, he is very meticulous and detail oriented with all his undertakings. Achieving unmatched results is both his passion and main priority. He causes these advancements because of his strong desire to innovate and lead others to embrace multiple emerging concepts which I believe makes his ideas unique and important for the industry" [Exhibit 82, page 382] [Exhibit 83, page 385].

2.5.4 National level NextITSM platform or Information System authorship

Another significant contribution in the field is the development of an original IT service management platform known as NextITSM. The Kazakh National Copyright Office issued Certificate No. 54827 for the NextITSM platform. This official document is dated February 18, 2025. It registers the computer program titled NextITSM. The certificate records the creation date as December 5, 2024. It lists the authors as Anuar Beisenbayev, Askar Taximov, and Bill Seitkazin. This registration confirms national ownership of the software. It grants exclusive intellectual property rights to the listed authors. The government document provides objective confirmation. It states that Mr. Beisenbayev is a co author of an original, enterprise grade IT service management platform. NextITSM
AuthorCertificate Exhibit Here

NextITSM is a platform aligned with the Information Technology Infrastructure Library (ITIL). It automates the full request and incident lifecycle for service organizations. This includes registration, execution, monitoring, and analytics. The platform controls service level agreements (SLA) and prioritizes tasks. It manages lifecycle statuses, problem management, and root cause analysis. It also provides knowledge base mailings and external integrations. The platform offers analytics, key performance indicators (KPIs), and role based access. NextITSM runs across the entire iKOMEK109 system. Call center operators, municipal service providers, and government agencies use it daily. In 2024, the system processed over 2,326 000 citizen requests. It achieved about 82% first contact resolution. The system made 98% on time referrals. It integrated more than 12 000 digital cameras. It also supported new AI based predictive monitoring. Figures from early 2025 show continued growth. These results are not general call center numbers. They show the

documented effect of the ITIL aligned workflows. These workflows, automation, and traceability are built into NextITSM.

Taken together, the evidence in this section shows that Mr. Taximov delivered sustained, measurable improvements in Astana’s city-scale digital governance and portfolio execution through mission-critical civic platforms and cross-agency coordination, reflecting excellence in IT project management. This excellence was formally recognized at the highest levels of government, including presidential commendations for national-scale initiatives and official recognition by the Mayor of Astana for his contributions to city digital infrastructure and successful execution of the 2022 extraordinary presidential election.

2.6 Evidence of Mr. Taximov’s authorship of scholarly articles in the field, in professional or major trade publications or other major media

Mr. Taximov has authored 13 scholarly and scientific articles that have been published in VAK peer-reviewed journals and conferences related to the field. The topics of these publications include smart-city analytics, municipal data engineering, open data and APIs, cybersecurity, and civic IT productization.

The Higher Attestation Commission (VAK) under the Ministry of Science and Higher Education of the Russian Federation is a national body responsible for scientific attestation. Among its core functions, VAK establishes requirements for peer-reviewed scientific journals and maintains an official list of journals approved for the publication of dissertation research for the degrees of Candidate of Science and Doctor of Science (PhD). Journals included in the VAK list are subject to editorial oversight and peer review standards [Exhibit 89, page 408].

Each publication listed below is included in the VAK register, as evidenced on the journals’ official websites and the screenshots provided as exhibits. This confirms that the articles were published in recognized scholarly journals with established editorial oversight.

Scientific paper: “Methodology for creating an effective IT ecosystem under resource constraints” (A.B. Taximov, A.A. Beisenbayev), published in: *Vestnik of Technological University*, Vol. 28, No. 4, 2025.

Vestnik of Technological University is a VAK-listed, peer-reviewed scientific journal publishing research in engineering and information technologies. The article presents a methodology for building operational IT platforms under limited financial and time resources. It addresses technology selection, data organization for real-world workloads, phased system deployment, and

management of technical debt to maintain long-term system stability. The paper further describes a practical, phased approach centered on delivering an MVP with open technologies and an Agile Scrum delivery model under tight budget and staffing constraints. It highlights an implementation case with compressed timelines and a small team structure, emphasizing performance and scalability objectives under limited infrastructure. [Exhibit 90, page 417] [Exhibit 91, page 423]

Scientific paper: “Information technology tools to improve urban life: iKomek experience”

(A.B. Taximov, D.R. Satvaldina), published in: *Components of Scientific and Technological Progress*, No. 4(94), 2024.

Components of Scientific and Technological Progress is a VAK-listed, peer-reviewed scientific journal published quarterly. The article analyzes the organizational and technical structure of the iKomek civic contact center, including omnichannel intake, request prioritization, responsibility assignment, and management dashboards. It traces the full lifecycle of a citizen request from initial contact to escalation to the city situation center and identifies architectural elements applicable to other municipalities. The article additionally outlines a structured, multi-level processing model in which operators receive requests, specialized teams manage complex cases, and organizations maintain end-to-end accountability for issue resolution. It also explains how the platform incorporates multiple communication channels and operational control tools, including reporting dashboards for city leadership and coordination using video and GPS monitoring where applicable. [Exhibit 92, page 426] [Exhibit 93, page 450]

Scientific paper: “Geonomics: address-registry maintenance and population heat-map analytics for smart-city operations”

(A.B. Taximov, A.A. Beisenbayev), published in: *Engineering Bulletin of the Don*, No. 9, 2024.

Engineering Bulletin of the Don is a VAK-listed, peer-reviewed electronic scientific journal published by the North-Caucasus Research Center of Southern Federal University.

The article introduces the Geonomics system and proposes an integrated methodological and algorithmic framework for maintaining up-to-date population and address data in large urban environments. The proposed model combines address registries, digital cartography, and government databases into a unified analytical platform that reduces inconsistencies in citizen registration data, minimizes manual errors, and improves the accuracy of territorial population analysis. The paper presents original algorithms for data standardization, polygon-based spatial analysis, automated voter-to-address linkage, and population heat-map generation, enabling reliable association of residents with administrative units and supporting data-driven urban planning and public service allocation. In addition, the article proposes a methodology for automated synchronization of residency data through structured integration with government registries, significantly improving data timeliness and consistency. The described geospatial

subsystems demonstrate practical effectiveness in planning social infrastructure such as schools and hospitals, contributing to more efficient use of municipal resources and improved service accessibility. [Exhibit 94, page 452] [Exhibit 95, page 467]

Scientific paper: “Possibilities of using open data: the concept of e-Democracy in smart-city management”

(A.B. Taximov, A.A. Beisenbayev), published in: *Innovations and Investments*, No. 11, 2023.

Innovations and Investments is a VAK-listed, peer-reviewed journal focused on economics, management, and innovation.

The article examines the role of open data in smart city governance and proposes a conceptual and architectural model for transitioning from passive data publication to an integrated, API-driven open data ecosystem. The proposed approach addresses key limitations of traditional open data portals, including data fragmentation, low reuse, and limited civic engagement. The article introduces an integrated open data architecture that consolidates heterogeneous datasets using ETL-based processing, standardized formats, and controlled API access, enabling secure and scalable data reuse while ensuring regulatory compliance. In addition, it proposes a citizen-centered governance framework that incorporates feedback mechanisms and dataset interaction, demonstrating how open data can support transparency, civic participation, and participatory decision making in smart city management. [Exhibit 96, page 471] [Exhibit 97, page 485]

Scientific paper: “Big data as a smart-city management tool”

(A.B. Taximov, A.A. Beisenbayev), published in: *Science and Business: Development ways*, No. 1(151), 2024 (section: Mathematical modeling and numerical methods).

Science and Business: Development ways is a VAK-listed, peer-reviewed journal used for publishing dissertation research. The article demonstrates how large-scale urban data can be applied as an operational management instrument. It connects data analytics to key performance indicators, planning processes, and resource allocation, describing end-to-end data pipelines and governance mechanisms across transport, social support, and municipal services. The paper further proposes concrete analytic use cases such as forecasting transport-network load using large-scale transaction and monitoring signals and using integrated data to identify high-risk anomalies in the urban environment. It also describes how big-data pipelines can support cross-agency operations, including public safety and social-service decision making, by turning heterogeneous city signals into actionable planning inputs. [Exhibit 98, page 489] [Exhibit 99, page 505]

Scientific paper: “Information technologies for updating and forming address information”

(A.B. Taximov, A.A. Beisenbayev), published in: *Herald of Computer and Information Technologies*

(VKIT), 2024, pp. 52–62 (DOI: 10.14489/vkit.2024.03.pp.052-062).

Herald of Computer and Information Technologies is a VAK-listed, peer-reviewed monthly journal focused on computer and information technologies. The article presents a data engineering system and algorithmic methodology for election period voter list formation that addresses incomplete and error prone registry data. The proposed solution integrates multiple government datasets into a unified pipeline with automated filtering, validation, and rule based exclusions aligned with electoral legislation. The article describes an end to end process for data extraction, normalization, eligibility filtering, and geographic assignment of voters to polling stations, significantly reducing manual intervention and human error. As a result, voter list accuracy increased from 84 percent to 100 percent during the election period. The article also outlines supporting public services, including a dedicated support center and digital verification tools, which enhanced transparency, citizen trust, and operational efficiency. [Exhibit 100, page 508] [Exhibit 101, page 528]

Scientific paper: “Efficiency improving strategy of international technology transfer in cybersecurity”
(A.B. Taximov), published in: *Automation. Modern Technologies*, No. 2(80), 2026, pp. 77-84
... (DOI:10.36652/vkit.004.05)

Automation. Modern Technologies is a VAK-listed, long-running peer-reviewed scientific and technical journal focused on automation and modern information technologies. The article analyzes the challenges of cross-border cybersecurity technology transfer under conditions of sanctions and limited access to foreign technological solutions and proposes a structured model to mitigate these constraints. It proposes cooperative models involving research centers, industry, and open-source tools, and provides structured recommendations for strengthening national cybersecurity capabilities. The article further develops a hybrid transfer model that combines external technology scouting, localized adaptation hubs, and a multi-stakeholder consortium approach to accelerate adoption while reducing dependency risks. In addition, the article outlines practical implementation mechanisms, including controlled parallel engineering where legally permissible and systematic participation in open-source ecosystems. These mechanisms are presented as effective tools for strengthening national cybersecurity capacity and improving resilience under restrictive international conditions. [Exhibit ??, page ??] [Exhibit ??, page ??]

Scientific paper: “Technology to integrate artificial intelligence into smart city control centers for faster decision-making”
(A.B. Taximov), published in: *Information Systems and Technologies*, 2026, No. 1(153) ...

Information Systems and Technologies is a VAK-listed, peer-reviewed scientific journal of Orel State University focused on information systems and information technologies. The article addresses information overload in smart city control centers and presents an author developed methodology for integrating artificial intelligence into decision support workflows. The proposed approach supports

operators in high intensity monitoring environments by structuring and prioritizing heterogeneous data streams while preserving human decision making. The article describes a modular architecture that integrates automated data collection, machine learning analytics, computer vision, predictive models, and a scenario based knowledge base within a unified operator interface, enabling the transformation of raw event streams into prioritized and explainable recommendations. An illustrative incident handling scenario demonstrates the full decision support cycle from event detection to operator confirmation. The human in the loop design reduces cognitive load and response time by filtering non critical information while keeping final decisions under operator authority.

2.7 Evidence of Mr. Taximov’s performance of a leading or critical role for organizations with a distinguished reputation

2.7.1 Municipal State Enterprise “iKOMEK109” City Monitoring and Rapid Response Center

iKOMEK109 is the capital city’s unified citizen-service and operational situation hub, combining 24/7 intake, real-time situational awareness (CCTV/IoT), and Big-Data analytics for systemic-issue detection and escalations to city leadership. The Deputy Mayor’s letter describes the organization’s scope explicitly:

“iKOMEK represents the city’s unified Situation Center comprised of: (1) the iKOMEK109 contact center [more than 2.2 million citizen requests per year], (2) the monitoring Situation Center with integrated camera networks, fire-prevention systems and Internet-of-Things solutions, and (3) the Analytics Center that works with Big Data to identify systemic issues and escalate them to the city’s leadership”.

Independent materials corroborate iKOMEK109’s official mandate and scale: the national government portal confirms iKOMEK109 as the consolidated 24/7 single contact point for municipal enterprises, lists the official omnichannel intake (109 short number, Akimat website, Telegram bot, iKOMEK109 and Smart Astana mobile apps, email), and reports a 2,500+ service catalog with 85% first-call resolution. Major press coverage reports million-scale request throughput, and the verified Instagram profile evidences sustained public-facing operations (230K followers, 5,937 posts). Accordingly, given its citywide mandate, million-scale annual request throughput, omnichannel public operations, and formal integration into the Akimat’s 24/7 situation and decision-support infrastructure, iKOMEK109 is widely regarded as a major, distinguished municipal organization in Astana [Exhibit 53, page 266] [Exhibit 57, page 286] [Exhibit 54, page 268].

As a Head-IT Project Manager of iKOMEK109, Mr. Taximov held a critical leadership role with control over core operational, technology, and governance functions. Deputy Mayor of Astana city

confirms Mr. Taximov's leadership position and emphasizes that his role is not merely technical, but executive and transformation-oriented:

"Askar Taximov has been the Head of the City Monitoring and Rapid Response Center 'iKOMEK109' since May 27, 2022. During his tenure, he has proven himself to be a highly professional and effective leader who makes significant efforts toward the digitalization, technological transformation, and innovative development of the company".

Baiken describes the scope of what iKOMEK109 is responsible for and the kinds of city operations it coordinates and controls:

"As part of the first stage of the technological transformation of the Akimat of the city of Astana, the 'iKOMEK109' Center was created, the main areas of activity of which are the reception of residents' requests, the coordination of the work of municipal and emergency services in resolving incidents and accidents, the control of timely closure of incidents and the identification and processing of incidents of offenses, and the building of a policy of preventive measures as well as operational control over the situation in the city in the 'here and now' mode through the city video surveillance system".

He explicitly attributes enterprise-wide optimization and service-quality improvements to Mr. Taximov's leadership after his appointment:

"From the moment of Askar Taximov's appointment to the position of head of the iKOMEK center, a course was taken toward significant optimization of processes and improvement of work in key areas such as the implementation of innovative solutions and increasing the efficiency of processing problematic issues, which made it possible to significantly improve the quality of services provided and interaction with the structural divisions of the Akimat".

Baiken further documents Mr. Taximov's city-level project governance leadership through the formal transformation and operation of a project management department:

"At the beginning of 2023, by the decision of the Akimat of the city, the Project Office of the Akimat of the city of Astana was transformed on the basis of iKOMEK109 into the Project Management Department. The main goal of the Department is to ensure effective interaction and coordination of all participants in project activities in the implementation of city development programs by applying project management methods and tools. Under the leadership and effective coordination of Askar Taximov, Scrum meetings were held with the structural divisions of the Akimat to manage projects in the information system using a project approach, through which key and strategic projects as well as activities to achieve KPI were determined. In addition, project charters were developed, projects were decomposed into specific tasks with deadlines, work with stakeholders was carried out, and project templates with central government bodies were developed".

Baiken confirms the scale of stakeholders involved in the project-governance system coordinated through iKOMEK109:

“Currently, 23 departments of the Akimat, 5 district Akimats, 2 territorial departments (the Police Department and the Department for Emergency Situations), and 75 quasi-public sector companies are involved in the implementation of project management.”

Baiken describes a governance method introduced by Mr. Taximov for closing urgent municipal problems and quantifies its results:

“As a result of the ‘Decision-Making Matrix’ method developed by Askar, for the results of 2023 and the first half of 2024 we were able to reduce the number of current problems under the ‘Especially Important’ and ‘Very Urgent’ criteria from 112 to 27, that is, by 76%”.

Baiken also provides quantified evidence of operational throughput improvements and closure of citizen requests:

“At the end of 2023, 426 542 requests were closed, which is 28.4% more than in 2022”.

Baiken documents citywide infrastructure outcomes tied to iKOMEK109’s systemic problem resolution work:

“As a result of this decision, from July 1, 2022, 31 systemic problems were closed, more than 80 children’s playgrounds were modernized, and 43 sports grounds were reconstructed. Lighting with a length of 378 km was installed in problem areas, which significantly improved safety and comfort for residents and reduced the crime rate by 27.3%”.

He reports expansion of the city’s surveillance infrastructure and its integration into city digital processing systems:

“The number of video surveillance cameras was increased from 9 752 to 10 581 (by 8.5%), and they were integrated into the city’s digital data processing system”.

Baiken describes safety-related operational improvements and law-enforcement support, including quantified results:

“As a result of process changes, the number of registered reports on the capture of drug ‘stash’ dealers using video surveillance cameras increased by 17% compared to the previous year. By the end of 2023, assistance was provided in solving 23 criminal offenses and 19 384 administrative offenses, of which 13 015 were documented by protocol. Due to Askar’s efforts, 52 008 750 tenge of paid fines were transferred to the budget using digital platforms based on issued administrative protocols”.

Baiken highlights that Mr. Taximov created internal technology capacity by establishing an R&D department and applying modern Data Science and Big Data tools, producing measurable improvements in citizen data accuracy:

“Another important unique and significant contribution of Askar Taximov to the sustainable development of the company iKOMEK109 was his creation in 2022 of a new structural subdivision,

the ‘Department of IT and Development (Research and Development Department),’ which on an ongoing basis updates the voter list in the territory of the city of Astana by identifying incorrect or outdated registration addresses of citizens and assigning them an address registration code. In its work, the Department uses advanced tools in the field of Data Science and Big Data, including programs and technologies such as Python, R, Apache Hadoop, Apache Spark, TensorFlow, as well as SQL and NoSQL databases”.

He describes that Mr. Taximov built internal product-development capacity and led the modernization of the iKOMEK 2.0 digital ecosystem, writing:

“Also, on the initiative of Askar Taksimov, the iKOMEK109 center began to specialize in the development of modern digital technologies and IT development. He formed a full-fledged team of qualified web developers and programmers, whose task was to modernize the current iKOMEK 2.0 ecosystem. To achieve this goal, Askar developed and approved a roadmap with clear deadlines and specific executors, which includes the following blocks:

- creation of a new version of the CRM system for more efficient reception of applications from residents;*
- ensuring integration with external services;*
- development of a tool for analyzing and managing requests and forming a rating of managers;*
- optimization of the current system’s database;*
- creation of convenient online channels with an intuitive interface and unified user registration”.*

Currently, the CRM system is fully released and processing daily requests 24/7, which is on average around 7000 requests (2 500 000 annually).

Moreover, besides his executive and technology-transformation responsibilities described above, Mr. Taximov delivered high-impact and critical improvements within the company:

- Increased inclusion by raising the number of employees with disabilities from 6 to 10.
- Expanded the youth workforce pipeline by scaling the youth practice program to 60+ participants.
- Reduced the backlog of long-unresolved “Waiting” requests by initiating closure with complete responses to residents. He also added HP Service Manager functionality so these cases could be processed correctly and reflected in analytics reports (including “Waiting” closures marked as “does not comply”).
- Institutionalized weekly escalation of the most urgent resident issues to the Akim’s leadership meeting. Using the “Decision-Making Matrix” method, iKOMEK109 reduced “Especially Important” and “Very Urgent” problems from 112 to 27 across 2023 and the first half of 2024, a 76% reduction.
- Strengthened public infrastructure improvement by actively promoting the “Budget of People’s Participation” program. From July 1, 2022, this work helped close 31 systemic problems, modernize 80+ children’s playgrounds, and reconstruct 43 sports grounds.

- Formed cross-agency working groups to inspect problem zones, set priorities, and embed them into multi-year budgeting for systematic rollout. This approach delivered 378 km of new street lighting in problem areas and reduced crime by 27.3%.
- Identified and coordinated fixes for systemic water supply and wastewater issues across the city. The letter reports 4 systemic problems identified and 3 successfully resolved, including high-complaint zones generating 3 000+ resident requests.
- Accelerated closure of hazardous open manholes by organizing accountability workflows to identify responsible asset holders. Over the last two years, 13 927 open manholes were eliminated, and the average closure time was reduced by two times.
- Improved situational-center performance by updating monitoring and analytics algorithms, optimizing registration and processing workflows, and issuing new operating instructions for video-based incident response. As a result, camera-based detections related to drug “stash” activity increased by 17% compared to the previous year, and in 2023 the center supported 23 criminal cases and 19 384 administrative offenses, with 52 008 750 KZT in paid fines transferred to the budget through digital platforms.
- Increased adoption of digital intake channels through a strategy focused on messengers and social media, including continuous monitoring of city public channels, feedback collection, awareness posts, and campaigns. This work increased requests via the Telegram chatbot and the iKOMEK109 mobile app by 22% in 2023 compared to the previous year.
- Improved staff performance and motivation by defending the budget and linking incentives to KPI performance. Since June 1, 2022, salaries increased by 51% for production staff and by 31% for administrative and managerial staff, and rank-and-file employees became eligible for bonuses of up to 4 monthly salaries.
- Secured housing-support access for employees by signing a cooperation memorandum with Otbasys Bank. This enabled voluntary payroll-to-deposit savings toward housing down payments and raised the employee loyalty index to 42.
- Launched a healthcare innovation collaboration that created a direct resident-to-clinic channel and improved appointment workflows. In the pilot phase, 150+ calls per week were processed in 4 medical organizations.

Baiken directly links iKOMEK109’s “high performance indicators” and transformation outcomes to Mr. Taximov’s management effectiveness and innovation: *“I note that the above projects, achievements, and high performance indicators of the company are the direct result of the effective management of Askar Taximov, and thanks to his innovative solutions the company was able to ensure technological development and digital transformation.”* [Exhibit 103, page 541]

2.7.2 Joint Stock Company “State Technical Service” National Cybersecurity Operator

STS is a distinguished, national-scale cybersecurity operator. State Technical Service (STS) is a national cybersecurity organization with a long-standing public mandate to protect Kazakhstan’s information space and the security of “electronic government” systems and critical information and communication infrastructure. STS publicly describes its mission as “ensuring Kazakhstan’s information security since 2008” and “creating a secure digital space by utilizing advanced technologies and cybersecurity expertise,” and it lists national-scale functions such as unified e-government gateways, state security testing of informatization objects, incident monitoring and coordination, operation of national coordination centers, and information-security certification support [Exhibit 59, page 295]. STS also maintains an active public communications footprint, including a public Instagram presence (1,232 posts shown in the record), supporting the organization’s prominence and sustained public-facing operations [Exhibit 60, page 300].

As an Independent Director and Board Member, Mr. Taximov held a critical leadership role overseeing cybersecurity directions and strategic development.

“In the position of independent director and member of the Board of Directors of the Joint Stock Company ‘State Technical Service’ (hereinafter – JSC ‘STS’), Askar Boranbayevich Taximov has been working since January 18, 2022, on the basis of the order of the Chairman of the National Security Committee of the Republic of Kazakhstan dated January 14, 2022. Within the framework of his work, Askar Taximov implements innovative projects and coordinates the company’s areas on issues of information and cybersecurity, and also heads the Strategic Development Committee of the Board of Directors.”

Zhunisebek describes an automation tool designed for continuous collection of information-security signals from official internet sources and Telegram media channels, implemented for routine use by STS units:

“Taking into account his experience and knowledge in the field of innovative and technological solutions, Askar Taximov was involved in the implementation of a Telegram bot for monitoring mass media, intended to automate the processes of searching for news regarding information security topics by specific tags from official Internet resources and Telegram channels of mass media. This Telegram bot was implemented for the subdivisions of JSC ‘STS’ and is used in everyday activities.”

Zhunisebek explains that Mr. Taximov participated in the creation of a portal that digitized and streamlined a compliance-critical testing service for e-government and critical infrastructure systems, reducing manual paperwork:

“In addition, Askar Taximov participated in the development of the Synaq Internet portal, implemented to automate the process of providing the service of testing informatization objects

of ‘electronic government’ and information systems classified as critical information and communication infrastructure objects for compliance with information security requirements. Development of Synaq made it possible to automate the testing process, significantly reduce document flow, and it is used in the activities of JSC ‘STS’ ”.

Zhunisbek highlights Mr. Taximov’s key role in the development of ScanKZ components, a national-scale system for collecting information about exposed devices and vulnerabilities to support analysis and prevention:

“As part of cross-sector coordination on issues of monitoring information security provision, protection, and the safe functioning of the Kazakhstan segment of the Internet, in 2023 JSC ‘STS’ carried out work to develop the ScanKZ search system for collecting information on the security level of devices connected to the Internet at the scale of the Kazakhstan Internet segment. Askar Taximov played a key role in the development of components of this system. As a result of the development of ScanKZ, an improvement in the current activities of KZ-CERT for preventing computer security threats was achieved due to the automatic identification of vulnerable objects in the network”.

In addition to the three flagship projects described above, the STS letter documents several further contributions that strengthen the “critical role” showing (1) national-level governance trust, (2) strategic oversight authority, and (3) practical operational impact on cybersecurity monitoring, compliance testing workflows, and KZ-CERT’s threat-prevention capability:

- Helped implement a media-monitoring automation that runs tag-based searches every 4 hours (and can be configured, including real-time monitoring if needed).
- Enabled automated discovery of cybersecurity-relevant mentions in official online sources by integrating Google Programmable Search Engine queries on a recurring schedule.
- Implemented an internal workflow that alerts STS staff with a direct link whenever a tagged keyword is detected in news/posts, improving speed of awareness and triage.
- Supported building a complete internal monitoring stack for this workflow, including a closed Telegram bot for managing tags/keywords and a closed Telegram chat where staff review the detected posts in an internal channel.
- Ensured the monitoring solution includes a database for storing collected news/posts and tag data, creating an auditable and searchable internal history.
- Introduced operational controls for this monitoring tool by implementing user management (add/remove users) and action logging, strengthening internal governance and accountability.
- Helped design Synaq as a full system with core infrastructure components, including a unified data repository and an administration module for managing users and logging actions.
- Supported an end-to-end digitized workflow in Synaq where applicants can form, approve, sign, and submit requests and applications for testing, reducing reliance on manual coordination.
- Enabled automatic cost calculation for electronic price quotations in Synaq, reducing manual

pricing work and standardizing quotation logic.

- Enabled applicants to download electronic protocols generated from testing results through Synaq, making compliance documentation accessible in a structured digital format.
- Contributed to ScanKZ capabilities that automatically collect and display technical security signals such as open ports and services, TLS/SSL certificates, WHOIS data, operating systems, subdomains/DNS records, and IP addresses, improving the completeness of exposure assessment.
- Strengthened KZ-CERT's operational follow-through by supporting a system that can inform and warn device owners when vulnerabilities are discovered, promoting faster remediation after detection.

Zhunisbek concludes that Mr. Taximov's technical expertise and innovative approach directly supported goal attainment and increased STS effectiveness in key operational directions:

"In the course of performing the above tasks, Askar Taximov demonstrated a high level of analytical thinking and professionalism, and his technical knowledge and innovative approach made it possible to achieve the set goals and, overall, to increase the efficiency of the activities of JSC 'STS' in certain areas of activity".

[Exhibit 105, page 556]

2.7.3 Limited Liability Partnership "Elorda Qurylys Kompaniyasy" Municipal Developer

EQK is a distinguished, city scale municipal developer with a high visibility public mission. Elorda Qurylys Company (EQK) is a municipal developer created to resolve problem shared equity housing, finance and finish stalled construction sites, and deliver apartments to equity holders. Public facing materials document continuous operations since 2018 and a sustained public mission focused on completing problematic projects and delivering housing under the city's development framework [Exhibit 61, page 302].

EQK's public record corroborates the organization's mandate and execution at scale. Public materials report completion of 141 residential buildings and re-housing of 15 500+ families, establishing EQK as the city's principal mechanism for resolving problem projects. The official website presents EQK's mission and a portfolio of delivered residential complexes (for example, completed projects showing apartment counts, status, and delivery dates), confirming the breadth and continuity of EQK's operations. EQK also maintains a sustained public communications footprint through its verified Instagram profile, evidencing ongoing stakeholder engagement and high visibility public activity. The screenshot in the record shows 468 posts (as of 2025)[Exhibit 62, page 306].

Mr. Taximov was appointed into a senior executive role at EQK, with delegated authority over both financial management and IT modernization, rather than a routine technical position:

“During his period of activity, from March to June 2022, Askar held the position of First Deputy General Director for financial and IT issues. In this relatively short time, he proved himself to be a highly qualified manager with the ability to find non-standard, innovative solutions and implement modern approaches in the company’s work”.

Tauekelov documents that Mr. Taximov secured large-scale financing that directly enabled completion of problematic facilities and delivered housing outcomes for thousands of families:

“Askar managed to obtain financing totaling 51 billion tenge from the National Fund of the Republic of Kazakhstan and the local budget. These funds made it possible to successfully complete work on 10 problematic facilities, including 27 residential buildings. As a result, more than 3000 families received the keys to their long-awaited apartments, obtained new housing, and the opportunity to start a new chapter of their lives”.

Tauekelov further explains that Mr. Taximov implemented a digital financial governance system that materially reduced costs and accelerated project delivery timelines:

“He developed and implemented a digital financial model in the company, which ensured transparency and targeted allocation of funds from the National Fund of the Republic of Kazakhstan, and from the republican and local budgets. After the implementation of the new model, which made it possible to control the budget in real time, forecast costs, and optimize logistics, the company reduced these costs by 30%, which led to savings of 156.9 million tenge annually. In addition, accurate planning and detailed data analysis made it possible to reduce the average commissioning time of facilities by 11% - from 24 months to 21 months. As a result of the implementation of the digital financial model, the company not only saved 156.9 million tenge, but also accelerated work processes, which led to profit growth of 7–9%”.

Tauekelov also describes how Mr. Taximov expanded completion capacity by attracting investors and enabling delivery through partnership with a major developer:

“Thanks to his negotiation and communication skills, Askar attracted investors totaling 30 billion tenge, which allowed the company to complete another 8 problematic facilities, including 12 multi-apartment residential complexes. He managed to attract the largest developer in Kazakhstan — BI Group”.

Tauekelov further documents that Mr. Taximov implemented real-time construction transparency and remote monitoring that reduced complaints and improved site security and safety outcomes:

“In addition, he ensured transparency of the process for equity holders, allowing them to watch the construction progress in real time through a video surveillance system using Computer Vision technology. The introduction of online viewing reduced the number of complaints from equity holders by 35%. According to operational reports of law enforcement agencies, the number of thefts

at construction sites decreased by 46%. The level of industrial injuries decreased on average by 2.3 times”.

Finally, Tauekelov describes Mr. Taximov’s introduction of BIM as a modern digital capability that reduced design and approval risks:

“One of Askar’s important achievements was the implementation of the digital BIM product (Building Information Modeling — information modeling technology), which allowed our company to effectively manage construction projects at every stage of their life cycle. Thanks to these solutions, errors and risks during the passage of project expertise decreased by 3.5 times in authorized bodies”.

In addition to the described above, the EQK letter documents further contributions that demonstrate sustained operational impact, modernization of governance, and measurable improvements in citizen-facing trust and construction safety:

- Analyzed EQK’s business processes and split them into functional blocks, which the letter links to fixing weak cross-department coordination and improving cost control.
- Built a structured planning system with normative, indicative, and descriptive plans, including plan–fact analysis and financial forecasting.
- Added vertical and horizontal analysis and introduced financial health indicators (liquidity, stability, profitability ratios) to create a complete picture of the company’s financial condition.
- Digitalized the entire financial governance model in 1C:ERP, automating data collection and management for end-to-end control. Implemented multi-level planning horizons inside the system (strategic, medium-term, short-term, tactical, and operational) so management could plan and manage funds across timeframes. Configured a Target Indicators Monitor and defined key metrics for each planning level to standardize performance tracking.
- Integrated and upgraded the Budgeting module with the financial system so leadership could view the company’s financial position in dashboards and charts.
- Defined operational control metrics inside the model, including funds raised, construction volume, procurement plans, number of facilities, suppliers, fixed assets, credit operations, indirect-cost reduction, and profitability, enabling detailed analytics by activity block.
- The letter notes the pre-existing problem he addressed: weak coordination and inefficient cost management caused annual losses of about 10% of the construction budget, stated as 523 million KZT.
- Developed a 10-step BIM implementation algorithm, from customer request for a BIM model through life-cycle updates and archiving of the digital model.
- Implemented BIM in a Common Data Environment (CDE) with role-based access, giving architects, engineers, and builders real-time access to current project data and improving coordination. The letter provides a specific BIM case: the 2022 “Turan–Syganak” residential complex was modeled using Model Studio Soft (four modules, including CADlib Model & Archive), producing a detailed 3D model that covered buildings and surrounding

infrastructure elements.

Tauekelov concludes by emphasizing the exceptional and irreplaceable nature of Mr. Taximov's contribution to EQK's transformation and results:

"In conclusion, I want to emphasize that Askar's contribution to the development of the company was invaluable" [Exhibit 106, page 560].

2.7.4 Joint Stock Company "Astana Innovations" Smart City Operator

JSC "Astana Innovations" is a distinguished, city-scale Smart City operator with sustained public mandate. Astana Innovations functions as the city's Smart City operator, responsible for core municipal digital infrastructure, including the Big Data platform, the evolution from open data to open APIs, and the telecom-duct infrastructure that underpins broadband connectivity. This is not a narrow internal IT unit, but a city-facing operator tasked with maintaining and expanding shared platforms used across municipal domains. The Board Chairman's recommendation letter further documents the organization's mandate, scope, and the concrete programs delivered under Mr. Taximov's leadership [Exhibit 107, page 565] [Exhibit 63, page 308]. Astana Innovations' official public materials corroborate its institutional role and continuity of operations. The organization's official website publicly presents its mission and scope across Smart Astana initiatives, Big Data, Open Data/Open APIs, and telecom-duct management, and it also publishes standard corporate-governance information and operational disclosures consistent with a city-scale operator. These public disclosures align with the institutional remit described in the recommendation letter and support the organization's distinguished reputation as the city's platform steward rather than a project-based contractor [Exhibit 63, page 308]. Astana Innovations also maintains an official public communications presence through its Instagram account "astana.innovations" identifying the organization and linking to its official domain. As of 2025, the account reflects 836 posts, supporting the organization's visibility as the city operator [Exhibit 64, page 313].

JSC "Astana Innovations" is a city-scale innovation integrator created to advance Kazakhstan's innovation economy and implement "Smart Astana" initiatives. The organization states:

"Our company JSC "Astana Innovation" was established in 2011 for the purpose of developing competitiveness and creating the most favorable conditions for the implementation of innovations in the economy of the Republic of Kazakhstan. The responsibility of the company makes it possible to integrate all available government instruments for supporting innovations for the successful implementation of projects at the city level. This enables the capital to make a breakthrough in the field of new technologies".

Kaldybayev, CEO of the Company, describes Mr. Taximov's critical role in scaling AIN's Big Data platform into a multi-source analytical system with measurable outputs:

“JSC ‘Astana Innovations’ is the operator of a Big Data platform, which represents a set of tools for data analysis and visualization, including the ‘Tulpar’ cartographic system, which was developed in 2018. He personally initiated further improvement of a platform capable of processing and analyzing large volumes collected from various city sources, which is about 76 databases. This product allowed our company to effectively identify trends, forecast needs, and develop targeted development strategies based on factual data”.

“With Askar’s unique knowledge and efforts, as a result 12 analytical data models were implemented and an additional block of text-and-graphic visualization of information was created. All these measures made it possible to resolve pressing issues in the field of passenger transportation and increase transportation efficiency on average by 17%”.

“As a result, TOP-40 addresses were identified in which 76 thousand people are registered. From government data sources, he identified a list of large families in the city in the amount of 14 601 families. Then he determined relationships with information about children to form a family passport, the number of which is 92 957 children”.

“All the above-listed results and achieved successes were obtained thanks to the professional efforts, experience, and high expertise of Askar Taximov, as well as his persistence and innovative solutions”.

Kaldybayev also explains that Mr. Taximov expanded the citizen-facing Smart Astana platform by proposing and implementing new services aligned with resident needs:

“Within the framework of the ‘Smart Astana’ concept, our company developed and launched a portal and a mobile application of the same name. These innovative solutions serve as a single interface for providing city services and public services, based on the principle ‘the whole city in your smartphone’. After carefully studying the current services and the needs of city residents, Askar Taximov proposed creating new services that would expand the functionality of the portal and the mobile application”.

“For example, under Askar’s supervision a service for checking the queue number as well as accepting documents for enrollment in kindergartens and schools of the city of Astana was implemented. In city hospitals, QR-code-based technologies were introduced, through which residents can scan a QR code in the ‘Smart Astana’ mobile application and leave feedback about the doctor’s work”.

“Thanks to this development, a systemic problem of falsification of medical certificates No. 086 and No. 083, as well as sick leave certificates and sanitary books, was solved”.

Beyond digital services, Kaldybayev documents Mr. Taximov’s operational modernization with quantified improvements in telecom infrastructure management:

“JSC ‘Astana Innovations’ is designated as the city’s managing company for the operation of cable duct infrastructure, which plays a key role in providing stable and high-speed internet, telephone communications, and other telecommunication services. Askar organized a phased reduction of the time for reviewing applications and issuing technical conditions from 30 calendar days to 14 days. Thanks to Askar’s efforts and determination, the number of agreements increased from 20 to

73, and total income reached from 38 million tenge to 152 million tenge in 2021, thus in a short period the city's cable duct activity moved from "loss-making" to "profitable".

In addition to the flagship outcomes described above, the AIN letter documents further Askar Taximov's contributions showing breadth of impact across Smart City service delivery, data governance, and election operational readiness:

- Built a Big Data decision-support stack that unified 104 data layers (from 76 databases) and displayed them on the city's digital map.
- Created an "Identifying the Self-Employed" Big Data model and delivered an export of identified self-employed residents to the Astana City Employment Center for follow-up action.
- Modernized the city transport decision-support system by updating the "Transport Model" and integrating it into the digital map with real-time stop-level load visibility, enabling route planning and improving passenger transportation efficiency by an average of 17%.
- Developed a machine-learning approach to resolve inconsistent address spellings (up to 6 variants for the same street) and used it to detect "rubber apartments", identifying TOP-40 addresses where 76 000 people were registered and transferring this information to migration authorities for verification.
- Built a Big Data "Profile of Large families" identifying 14 601 large families and linking child data to form family passports covering 92 957 children, including geocoordinates and map-based analytics for social-support planning. As a result of this profiling tool, social protection agencies gained map-based capabilities to see where large families live, track children counts, form a mother's passport, and plan support programs based on identified needs.
- Implemented open-data automation by converting city data outputs into Open API services (not only file downloads), enabling users to retrieve up-to-date data automatically via scripts, while still supporting downloads in .xls, .csv, and .json.
- Delivered a public open-data portal that provides 20 datasets across 9 categories (e.g. education, healthcare, transport, housing and communal services, city services, internet, ecology, news/events), expanding structured access to city data.
- Implemented an analytics workflow for election-related online services using Elasticsearch + Kibana, and built a daily Python (Pandas) log-processing script that loads service logs into PostgreSQL for SQL-based reporting by Individual Identification Number, district, and city.
- Improved voter registry accuracy in Astana from 84.4% (Jan 1, 2020) to 100% (Dec 1, 2020), raising the capital from last place to a leading position by registry relevance.
- Updated address records for 50 000+ citizens by assigning address registration codes and synchronizing corrected data into the national "Individuals" database through migration-service corrections.
- Enabled automated precinct assignment by adding geolocations for 8 000+ building addresses on the precinct digital map, and he also reduced precinct over-capacity issues by cutting the

number of precincts exceeding the constitutional norms from 101 to 10.

Kaldybayev concludes by directly tying these results to Mr. Taximov’s professionalism and high value to the organization:

“All the above-mentioned results and achievements of our company are directly related to the high professionalism and diligent contribution of Askar Taximov. His merits in our company are invaluable and deserve a high assessment”.

2.8 Comparable evidence of public display of work

Under 8 C.F.R. § 204.5(h)(4), when a criterion in § 204.5(h)(3), such as artistic exhibitions or showcases, does not directly apply to the occupation, USCIS may consider comparable evidence. IT-related work and applied research are not typically presented in artistic exhibitions. Instead, professionals in this field publicly display their work through technical conference presentations, scholarly papers, and industry forums, where project architectures, methodologies, and implementation case studies are presented and archived in citable proceedings or repositories. Therefore, the materials below demonstrate evidence of comparable public display.

Participation in the conference “Digitalization and technological revolutions: current challenges and opportunities”, 12 July 2025.

The work includes the paper “How to detect multi-level cyber threats in real time with AI and behavioral pattern analysis”. The paper presents an author-developed artificial intelligence-based detection methodology for real-time identification of complex, multi-level cyber threats using behavioral pattern analysis instead of static signature matching. It proposes a system architecture and detection logic that analyze behavioral deviations across multiple layers to identify coordinated and previously unknown attack patterns. The paper also reports an experimental evaluation comparing the proposed AI-based approach with traditional detection methods, demonstrating its effectiveness in identifying sophisticated threats in dynamic environments. The conference was organized by the International Centre for Innovative Research “Omega Science,” and the proceedings were published as a citable volume available through academic libraries [Exhibit 108, page 572] [Exhibit 109, page 582] [Exhibit 110, page 584] [Exhibit 111, page 603].

Participation in the International Scientific practical conference “World science: Problems and Innovations”, 30 May 2025.

The work includes the paper “Algorithm for Developing post-quantum cryptography to protect critical infrastructure against quantum attacks”. The paper proposes a lattice-based cryptographic approach designed to improve resilience against future quantum-computing threats. It outlines the mathematical model, algorithmic structure, and performance characteristics in comparison

with existing cryptographic schemes. The conference was organized by the International Centre for Scientific Cooperation “Science and Education” and the proceedings were publicly released with bibliographic records [Exhibit 115, page 626] [Exhibit 116, page 628] [Exhibit 117, page 645].

Participation in the conference “Modern technologies in technical and natural sciences”, 5 June 2025.

At the conference, A. Taximov presented the work “Optimization of cloud system performance using adaptive machine learning algorithms.”. The paper addresses the practical problem of maintaining stable cloud performance under rapidly changing workloads and proposes applying adaptive ML methods to automate key optimization decisions, including workload forecasting, resource auto scaling, database query optimization, and anomaly detection, thereby reducing manual tuning and performance degradation. The conference was organized and proceedings were published as a citable volume by the International Institute for Advanced Studies named after Lomonosov [Exhibit 112, page 605] [Exhibit 113, page 607] [Exhibit 114, page 624].

Participation in the National Scientific practical conference “Modern methods and innovations in science”, 12 May 2025.

The work includes the paper “Mechanism of accelerated transfer of technologies from scientific laboratories to industry of Kazakhstan”. The conference proceedings identify the included materials as selected scientific works recommended for publication by the editorial and publishing council of the Humanitarian National Research Institute “Natsrazvitie.” The paper presents an author-developed mechanism for accelerating technology transfer in Kazakhstan and proposes a model approach built around the creation and integration of the Technology Transfer Ecosystem Platform. This proposed platform model is designed to reduce barriers to commercialization by structurally linking science, industry, and the state within a single ecosystem. The paper outlines the stages of technology transfer, defines the functions of key participants, and specifies the infrastructure and regulatory conditions required to implement the model, with the expected result of faster and more coordinated commercialization of scientific developments in Kazakhstan. The conference was organized by the Humanitarian National Research Institute “Natsrazvitie” [Exhibit 120, page 668] [Exhibit 121, page 670] [Exhibit 122, page 685].

Participation in the International scientific practical conference “Scientific Forum: Innovative Science”, No. 6 (85), 28 June 2025.

The work includes the paper “Methodology of data transfer protocol standardization for cross-platform integration of IoT devices”. The paper proposes a standardized protocol framework for interoperable communication among heterogeneous IoT devices. It describes protocol architecture, integration mechanisms, and system-level efficiency improvements. The conference proceedings list the paper in the official table of contents, and the electronic version is archived in national scientific repositories and academic databases, confirming its formal publication and public

availability. The conference was organized by the International Centre for Innovative Research and Publishing “MCNO” and published as part of a citable international scientific proceedings volume (ISSN 2542-1255) [Exhibit 118, page 647] [Exhibit 119, page 649].

Participation in the Forum “Profit Contact Day 2025: New technologies in contact centers”, 13 June 2025.

The work includes a report and presentation titled “Digital transformation of a city platform: experience of creating iKOMEK 2.0”. The official program and event materials document the public presentation of his work, including coverage of his on-stage presentation. The presentation publicly showcased the architecture and implementation approach for upgrading a municipal contact-center platform into iKOMEK 2.0, including digital workflow redesign, omnichannel service logic, and modernization of the city platform’s operational model for citizen requests. The forum was held in Almaty at the InterContinental hotel in offline and online format, with 200+ offline participants and 1000+ online viewers, and focused on innovative technologies for contact centers, including AI and automation [Exhibit 28, page 171].

Participation in the conference “Profit Smart City Day 2024”, 11 October 2024.

The work includes presentation with a title “Smart City: The role of the iKOMEK109 situation center in ensuring city safety and identifying housing and utility problems”. The presentation materials, together with an official invitation letter and photographic evidence, document the public display of the work. The presentation demonstrated the architecture and operational model of the iKOMEK109 situation center, including AI-assisted monitoring, integration of large-scale video infrastructure, and automated coordination of municipal services. The event was organized by Profit Events and focused on urban digital transformation in Kazakhstan [Exhibit 125, page 706].

Participation in the conference “Profit Education Day 2023”, 20 October 2023 dedicated to the digitalization of education in Kazakhstan.

Mr. Taximov delivered a presentation titled “iKOMEK109: education, IT, and urban development,” in which he presented the applied use of urban digital platforms in the education sector. The presentation demonstrated how the iKOMEK109 situation center architecture is used to monitor, analyze, and respond to education-related incidents, including citizen requests concerning schools, kindergartens, and educational infrastructure. The report showcased real operational data, omni-channel citizen interaction, analytics dashboards, and interdepartmental coordination mechanisms, illustrating the practical integration of city IT systems into education governance. The public display of the work is documented through the official conference program, speaker listings, presentation materials, and photographic evidence of the presentation. The event was organized by Profit Events as part of the annual Profit Education Day forum and brought together representatives of government bodies, universities, IT companies, and education-sector decision-makers, focusing on digital transformation, EdTech solutions, cloud platforms, and

information security in education [Exhibit 123, page 687].

Participation in the conference “Profit Smart City Day 2023,” 15 September 2023.

The work includes a public presentation titled “iKOMEK109 today”. The presentation materials, together with the official conference program, speaker listings, and video recordings, document the public display of Mr. Taximov’s work. The presentation demonstrated the architecture, operational model, and real-world deployment of the iKOMEK109 city situation center, including centralized intake of citizen requests, integration with municipal and emergency services, large-scale video surveillance infrastructure, and data-driven coordination of city services. The presentation highlighted practical results of digital city governance, including improved incident detection, service response coordination, and analytics-supported decision-making at the municipal level. The event was focused on digitalization of cities, smart-city infrastructure, video analytics, urban safety, and automated public-service management, with participation from government regulators, city administrations, and industry experts [Exhibit 124, page 698].

Participation in the Digital Festival “Google DevFest Taraz 2023”, 16–17 November 2023.

The work includes the presentation and technical case study “City center for monitoring and operational response iKOMEK109 and project QalaQyzmet”. The case study describes the design and implementation of a unified digital platform integrating municipal utility services into a single window online “One Stop Shop”. The presentation demonstrated how the iKOMEK109 platform integrates multiple municipal services such as housing and utilities, incident reporting, service requests, and notifications within one coordinated digital interface. The proposed “one-stop shop” model enables residents to submit requests, track resolution status, and receive updates across multiple city services through a single entry point, eliminating fragmentation and reducing response time. The case study covered system architecture, inter-service integration, secure data exchange, and automated user-notification mechanisms, illustrating how disparate municipal systems are orchestrated into a coherent operational workflow. The event was Organized by the Governance of Zhambyl Region in partnership with Google Developers Group and Zhambyl Hub. The goal was to foster regional digitalization and IT talent [Exhibit 126, page 715].

Across these events, Mr. Taximov’s own developed digital platforms, system architectures, and applied implementation methodologies were publicly presented at scientific and industry conferences and documented in official programs, proceedings, and event materials. Because traditional artistic exhibitions do not apply to IT project management, these public conference presentations constitute comparable evidence of public display under 8 C.F.R. § 204.5(h)(4).

2.9 Evidence that Mr. Taximov has commanded a high salary relative to others in the field

The following section presents independent, third-party salary benchmarks for Astana, Republic of Kazakhstan, for the occupation of IT Project Manager. These sources establish baseline market compensation levels in the same geographic labor market and are used for comparison against Mr. Taximov's documented earnings.

- HR Praktika (Official Salary Certificate) HR Praktika issued a signed salary certificate defining typical job duties and qualification requirements for an IT Project Manager in Astana. The certificate applies an averaging methodology across multiple professional compensation studies (including People Consulting, EY, Habr, and hh.ru) and reflects prevailing base salary levels in the market.
 - Monthly Salary: 500,000 KZT
 - Annualized Total: 6,000,000 KZT [Exhibit 127, page 718]
- HeadHunter.kz (Official Letter) A signed letter from HeadHunter Kazakhstan reports the 2024 mean monthly salary for IT Project Manager positions in Astana, calculated from vacancies published on its national recruitment platform.
 - Monthly Salary: 442,000 KZT
 - Annualized Total: 5,304,000 KZT [Exhibit 129, page 726] [Exhibit 130, page 728]
- RecCom Recruiting (Market Overview) RecCom Recruiting provided a signed and sealed 2024 market overview for Astana. The overview defines role scope and summarizes compensation data derived from recruitment and placement activity for IT Project Managers.
 - Monthly Salary: 558,000 KZT
 - Annualized Total: 6,696,000 KZT [Exhibit 131, page 730]
- Bureau of National Statistics (Official Government Letter) The Department of the Bureau of National Statistics for Astana issued official response No. 2025 03546738 (dated 13 October 2025). The data is derived from the nationwide “*Report on the Structure and Distribution of Wages*” (Index 2–T) and is classified under the National Classifier of Occupation for ICT and project-management roles.
 - Monthly Salary: 758,791 KZT
 - Annualized Total: 9,105,492 KZT [Exhibit 132, page 733]

A formal *Salary Statement* issued by the Municipal State Enterprise iKOMEK109 documents Mr. Taximov's compensation for his position titled as a Head-IT Project Manager for 2024 [Exhibit 133, page 736]:

Total Gross Earnings for 2024: 36,280,907.9 KZT

The USD equivalent below is provided for reference only and is calculated using the National Bank of Kazakhstan average exchange rate for 2024 (468.99 KZT/USD):

$$\frac{36,280,907.9 \text{ KZT}}{468.99 \text{ KZT/USD}} \approx 77,360 \text{ USD}$$

The table below compares Mr. Taximov's documented annual earnings against independent market benchmarks for the same occupation and geographic area.

Benchmark Source	Market Annual	Candidate Annual	Ratio
HR Praktika	6,000,000 KZT	36,280,908 KZT	6.0×
HeadHunter.kz	5,304,000 KZT	36,280,908 KZT	6.8×
RecCom Recruiting	6,696,000 KZT	36,280,908 KZT	5.4×
Bureau of National Statistics	9,105,492 KZT	36,280,908 KZT	4.0×

According to independent statistics and national wage data, Mr. Taximov's earnings are up to from 4.0 to 6.8 times higher than the average salary in the field.

3 Final merits determination

In accordance with the Kazarian opinion, the subsecond step of the two-part approach is a final merits determination that considers all of the evidence in the context of whether the beneficiary meets the required level of high achievement and sustained national reputation in the field.

The aggregated evidence establishes that Mr. Taximov not only meets the regulatory criteria, but also that he has been recognized nationally as an authority in IT Project Management and Digital Governance.

3.1 Mr. Taximov has risen to the very top of the field of IT Project Management

Mr. Taximov is an expert of extraordinary ability who has risen to the very top of his field. His standing is confirmed by independent experts, national recognition, and mass media coverage.

Leading experts confirm Mr. Taximov's extraordinary technical skills and impact.

Dr. Chingiz Kenshimov (Computer Vision PhD).

Dr. Kenshimov explains Mr. Taximov's work on product architecture and leadership of research teams. Dr. Kenshimov writes:

"Askar is a true professional in information technology and innovation. His technical skills, strategic thinking, and ability to build scalable architectures make him one of the best experts in the field of digitalization. He consistently proposes practical, modern solutions and then drives them through implementation with high standards. His contributions have long-term impact and strengthen the broader digital ecosystem." [Section 2.5, page 28] [Exhibit 74, page 346]

Kakhar Kashimov (Chief Software Architect).

Mr. Kashimov (MSc, Imperial College London) highlights co-founding work with Mr. Taximov on wireless geophone sensor networks and emphasizes his ability to translate research concepts into large-scale, real-world systems. Mr. Kashimov writes:

"I confidently recommend Askar Taximov as one of the best and most competent specialists in Kazakhstan in the field of information technology and digitalization. He consistently demonstrates top-tier expertise and delivers high-impact technology solutions at scale. He combines strong engineering judgment with innovation, and he turns complex ideas into working systems. He is a strategic technical leader whom teams rely on when outcomes must be delivered under real constraints." [Section 2.5, page 28] [Exhibit 71, page 335]

Azamat Sanatov (Presidential Administration).

Mr. Sanatov describes Mr. Taximov's advanced capabilities in cybersubsecurity and IT infrastructure, emphasizing that his role is both technical and methodological. Mr. Sanatov writes:

"Askar is one of the best high-qualified specialists in Kazakhstan in information subsecurity, cybersubsecurity, and IT infrastructure. His expertise and practical leadership are recognized at the highest levels and reflect standing at the very top of the field. He approaches subsecurity as a complete system: policy, process, technology, and accountability. His work strengthens institutional resilience and helps organizations reduce exposure to cyber threats." [Section 2.5, page 28] [Exhibit 86, page 397]

A. Zhunisbek (Chairman of the Board, State Technical Service JSC).

Chairman Zhunisbek links Mr. Taximov to national information subsecurity projects and confirms his strategic authority within STS governance structures. Chairman Zhunisbek writes:

"Askar Taximov demonstrated a high level of analytical thinking and professionalism and played a key role in the development and implementation of national-level information subsecurity systems. His contribution confirms his position among top experts in the field. He is trusted with projects that require both strategic oversight and technical depth. His approach improves effectiveness and supports the subsecure functioning of critical digital infrastructure." [Section 2.5, page 28] [Exhibit 68, page 324]

His status at the top of the field is solidified by the highest state honors and major authorship. Mr. Taximov was awarded the state medal "Eren enbegi ushin" (*For Distinguished Labour*) by the President of the Republic of Kazakhstan, a distinction reserved for the highest achievers in the nation ([Section 2.1, page 6]).

Furthermore, he authored the NextITSM platform, a system of major significance that processed over 2.3 million citizen requests in 2024, acting as the digital backbone of the capital's monitoring center [Section 2.5, page 28].

Mr. Taximov serves as a recognized authority for national strategic initiatives. His leadership role was highlighted by *Forbes Kazakhstan*, which mentioned him in the context of municipal digital transformation [Exhibit 57, page 286].

Consequently, Mr. Taximov is consistently invited as an expert speaker for major forums, including the subsecurex Plenary Session, the Ministry of Defense digitalization panel, and the Digital Almaty forum that were noted by top experts in [Section 2.5, page 28]. Independent experts confirm his repeated invitations to high-profile international and national stages such as GITEX Global and Profit Smart City Day ([Exhibit 125, page 706]). Ainur Sidelkovskaya notes that his appearances at "prestigious venues as GITEX Global, Profit Smart City Day... always arouse keen interest among the audience", reflecting sustained peer recognition of his authority [Exhibit 82, page 382].

She further emphasizes that he “*actively shares his experience and knowledge with the professional community*”, which is why organizations repeatedly seek his expert participation [Exhibit 82, page 382]. Kakhar Kashimov likewise confirms that Mr. Taximov advances the field through “*popularizing his innovative ideas and developments*” and by “*speaking at various conferences on issues of digitalization and integration of IT-solutions*” [Exhibit 71, page 335]. These repeated invitations show that Mr. Taximov is engaged not as a ceremonial participant, but for practical expertise in Smart City delivery, Big Data governance, and cybersubsecurity-focused digital transformation ([Section 2.5, page 28]).

The below shown documents prove that Mr. Taximov is continuously invited to various events as an expert in the Information Technologies field:

- Digital Almaty 2024 (forum invitation). [Exhibit 137, page 746]
- Securex 2024 (invitation and business program). [Exhibit 145, page 766] [Exhibit 146, page 768]
- KazHackStan 2024 (cybersecurity conference invitation). [Exhibit 141, page 757]
- GITEX 2024 in Dubai (OpenText customer delegation). [Exhibit 139, page 753]
- OpenText Europe 2024 in Prague (customer conference invitation). [Exhibit 143, page 761]
- MOST Hub defense digitalization panel (expert invitation). [Exhibit 142, page 759]
- Profit Infrastructure Day 2025 (conference invitation). [Exhibit 144, page 763]
- Kaspersky Security Day 2023 (conference materials). [Exhibit 140, page 755]

3.2 Mr. Taximov has sustained national and international acclaim in his field of expertise

Mr. Taximov has not only achieved national acclaim but has sustained this recognition over a continuous period, evidenced by a consistent trajectory of awards, media appearances, and expert roles.

His recognition by the Head of State and municipal leaders has been sustained over multiple years. Mr. Taximov received an Honorary Diploma from the Mayor of Astana in 2022 and 2024. The President of the Republic of Kazakhstan sent him personal Letters of Appreciation in 2022 and 2024. The President awarded him the state medal “Eren enbegi ushin” (*For Distinguished Labour*) in October 2025. These continuous high-level awards demonstrate that he has sustained his national recognition ([Section 2.1, page 6]).

He is a recurring subject of interest for major media outlets. The media consistently seeks Mr. Taximov's expertise to explain complex digital trends to the public. His media presence includes various interviews, such as a distinguished alumnus feature for L.N. Gumilyov ENU, a technical discussion on "Smart City" technologies for HubTalks, and a live broadcast interview on iKOMEK operations for the TV program *By Trends*.

Mr. Taximov is continuously invited as an expert to guide the next generation of specialists. Demonstrating his sustained authority, he is frequently invited to evaluate professional competitions. He served as a speaker at Google DevFest [Exhibit 126, page 715] and ProffIT Day [Exhibit 144, page 763], and has served on an ongoing basis as an honorary jury member for the ITeachMe Foundation's OrleTECH finals, evaluating projects in NoCode, AI, and UX/UI design. [Section 2.4, page 19]

Mr. Taximov's sustained acclaim is further evidenced by scholarly authorship that documents and disseminates his original, field-tested methods for smart-city delivery and data governance [Section 2.6, page 40]. Independent experts confirm that these were practical innovations formalized as professional or peer-reviewed works. Dr. Kenshimov states: "*Askar Taximov published five scientific articles presenting unique approaches and algorithms to improve urban infrastructure and automate administrative processes*". He adds: "*In one of his papers, he developed algorithms for interacting with government databases to automatically update individual citizen data, significantly improving the accuracy and timeliness of these records*" [Exhibit 74, page 346]. Mr. Sanatov emphasizes his applied value: "*He made substantial contributions by developing practical methods and instructions on urgent IT-industry problems, which were reflected in his scientific and practical articles*" [Exhibit 86, page 397]. Ainur Sidelkovskaya confirms the governance importance of this work: "*In his groundbreaking article, 'How to use the geonomics information system to update and generate citizen data', Askar addressed the critical challenge of maintaining accurate and up-to-date citizen data, a fundamental requirement for effective urban governance*". These publications show that Mr. Taximov's solutions are not only implemented in practice, but are formalized and disseminated as recognized methods, which is characteristic of a top-tier expert whose work influences how others in the field operate [Exhibit 82, page 382].

The above presented evidences clearly show that Mr. Taximov has been nationally recognized as outstanding in his field. His work has both substantial merit and national importance, directly strengthening the country's cybersubsecurity posture and municipal efficiency. As such, Mr. Taximov meets the requirements for the EB-1A classification as a person of extraordinary ability.

4 Mr. Taximov’s proposed employment has both substantial merit and national importance for the United States

The United States labor market demands skilled IT Project Managers. The U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics lists the 2024 median pay at \$100,750. It also predicts employment growth of 6% from 2024 to 2034. This rate exceeds the average for all jobs (BLS, 2024). Executing complex digital programs requires local hiring across complementary roles such as developers, delivery leads, SRE/DevOps specialists, data engineers, ITSM administrators and cybersecurity analysts, supporting ongoing U.S. based operations rather than one off deployments (BLS, 2024). At the same time, the market for project management tools is expanding quickly, projected to reach \$20.47,billion by 2030 at an annual growth rate of 15.7%, with North America holding 41.97% of the 2022 market (Grand View Research, 2023). Organizations lose an estimated \$2 trillion annually due to failed or underperforming projects, roughly \$1 million every 20 seconds (PMI, 2024). Large studies of IT portfolios document “black swan” overruns with severe operational and fiscal consequences across both private and public sectors (Flyvbjerg & Budzier, 2022 and Flyvbjerg et al., 2025). By 2030, AI is expected to automate up to 80% of routine project management tasks, with humans focusing on higher value strategic leadership (HBR, 2023). These trends confirm that disciplined, AI aware IT project leadership has substantial merit for the U.S. economy. Aging infrastructure, climate shocks, and staff shortages burden U.S. municipalities (SmartBrief, 2025 and Zacua Ventures, 2024). Independent analyses show that Smart City tools raise efficiency by 20 to 3%. The U.S. Smart Cities market alone is projected to reach about \$260.9,billion by 2028, evidencing strong domestic demand for interoperable and secure platforms (MarketsandMarkets, 2024). Small and mid sized cities, in particular, need affordable and secure systems that improve service delivery despite limited budgets and staff (Lincoln Institute of Land Policy, 2024).

Mr. Taximov’s experience was formed in a *mature digital government ecosystem*. International assessments such as the UN e-Government Survey and regional development bank analyses consistently rank Kazakhstan among higher performing e-Government environments in Asia (UN e-Government Survey and Asian Development Bank synthesis). Strong private sector adoption, including multi service “super app” platforms (for example, international coverage of Kaspi.kz), complements this environment. Within that context, Mr. Taximov has led the design and implementation of digital urban monitoring systems, citizen service and CRM platforms, predictive analytics pipelines and cybersecurity architectures, deployed at scale in production environments. This dual public and private background prepares him, as an IT Project Manager, to navigate civic constraints, regulatory requirements and market driven pressures that are comparable to those facing U.S. jurisdictions.

The methods documented in his record include requirements baselining, KPI and SLA regimes,

iterative release trains, data quality pipelines, AI and analytics instrumentation and security by design. They map directly onto U.S. initiatives to

- Update and check 3 1 1 service systems. Handle incidents quickly. Track every case. (McKinsey, 2018 and Flyvbjerg & Budzier, 2022)
- Expand reliable, low-cost open data programs. They support transparency and new ideas. (Lincoln Institute of Land Policy, 2024)
- Protect critical infrastructure. Old assets face stress from weather and high demand. We must monitor them constantly to prevent cyber attacks. (SmartBrief, 2025)
- Use affordable digital tools in small and medium cities. Towns should use standard software. Custom systems carry too much risk. (Lincoln Institute of Land Policy, 2024)

Taken together, the above shows a strong national demand for IT project leaders, large digitalization needs in municipal systems and critical infrastructure, and substantial economic losses from poor execution. Within this landscape, Mr. Taximov's demonstrated record of designing, implementing and operating large scale municipal platforms through rigorous IT Project Management methodologies, improving service delivery, cost control and cybersecurity, positions him to deliver quantifiable value to U.S. jurisdictions. By leading cross functional teams, managing complex technical requirements and ensuring on time and on budget delivery, particularly in small and mid sized municipalities, his proposed work will help close critical modernization gaps, strengthen public services and create skilled employment in underserved regions, thereby advancing U.S. national interests.

5 Conclusion

Mr. Taximov is a professional IT project manager recognized nationally and internationally, which is confirmed by his awards, memberships, published materials, judging activities original contributions, scholarly articles, leadership roles and high remuneration. He intends to continue his work as IT project management in the United States. His permanent residency will be beneficial for the digital transformation and information technology sectors in the United States.

Mr. Taximov fully satisfies all requirements of *INA Section 203(b)(1)(A)* and *8 CFR Section 204.5(h)*. Please kindly approve Mr. Taximov's petition for permanent residence under the category of an alien of extraordinary ability.

Statement from Mr. Taximov detailing plans on how he intends to continue work in the United States

My name is Askar Taximov. I am the beneficiary of this I-140 Immigrant Petition for Alien Worker, seeking EB-1A classification as an individual of extraordinary ability. I intend to continue my professional work in the United States in IT project management in the field of urban digital infrastructure, innovation and delivery for local governments.

I will build a consulting and product practice dedicated to municipal IT project management and execution. The practice will deliver incident and service management platforms modeled on my prior NextITSM architecture and the operating model developed and proven at iKOMEK 2.0. Each engagement will apply disciplined delivery mechanics, requirements baselining and scope control, governance charters, KPI and service level agreement (SLA) taxonomies, risk, issue and change management, iterative release trains, data quality and machine learning operations (MLOps) pipelines, and security by design to ensure schedule, budget and benefit realization in production environments.

I plan to collaborate directly with U.S. municipalities to adapt, implement and manage Smart City components that I have validated in practice, using modern IT project management methods and tooling, Agile delivery, KPI and service level agreement (SLA) governance, continuous integration and continuous delivery (CI/CD), and machine learning operations (MLOps) to achieve-Goals efficiently and expeditiously. Initial deployments will prioritize (i) a cloud platform for omnichannel citizen request intake, routing and service level agreement (SLA) tracking, (ii) artificial intelligence (AI) assisted triage and analytics for pattern detection and demand forecasting, (iii) video analytics for public safety and operations use cases, and (iv) executive dashboards for transparent performance management. These solutions are particularly relevant for jurisdictions up to approximately 1 million residents, where budgets are constrained but the need for digitalization is acute.

In parallel, I will launch a pilot “Smart Response” program with one U.S. city, adapting the iKOMEK approach to local constraints. The platform will follow low code principles, use an open source first modular stack, and offer a flexible licensing model to keep total cost of ownership low and long term operations sustainable for local administrations. This work is designed to deliver tangible outcomes for problems common to small and mid sized cities, including overloaded municipal services, the lack of a unified digital environment for receiving and resolving resident requests, fragmented data, and outdated channels between residents and administration. The same methods and architectures that proved effective in my prior programs can be adapted to U.S. conditions to close this technology gap, accelerating digitalization of city infrastructure, improving management efficiency and lowering cost to serve, thereby benefiting the United States.

The implementation of my projects will directly contribute to job creation and the strengthening of economic activity. In the course of this work, I plan to hire professionals in key areas, including project managers, analysts, data engineers, implementation specialists and technical support staff. This will generate formal employment, increase tax revenues and provide a direct economic benefit. Part of these teams will be established in mid sized cities using a hybrid work model that combines on site and remote participation. This approach enables the creation of jobs and economic activity not only in major metropolitan areas but also in cities with population up to one million residents, ensuring a stable and positive impact on local economies.

This plan represents a direct continuation of my established professional path in IT infrastructure development, digital governance and economic efficiency. My work in the United States will contribute by improving municipal systems, strengthening cybersecurity practices, creating jobs in underserved regions and notably enhancing the quality and responsiveness of city services. With my expertise as an IT project manager, I am well positioned to execute this plan effectively and achieve its stated goals.

Sincerely,

Askar Taximov